

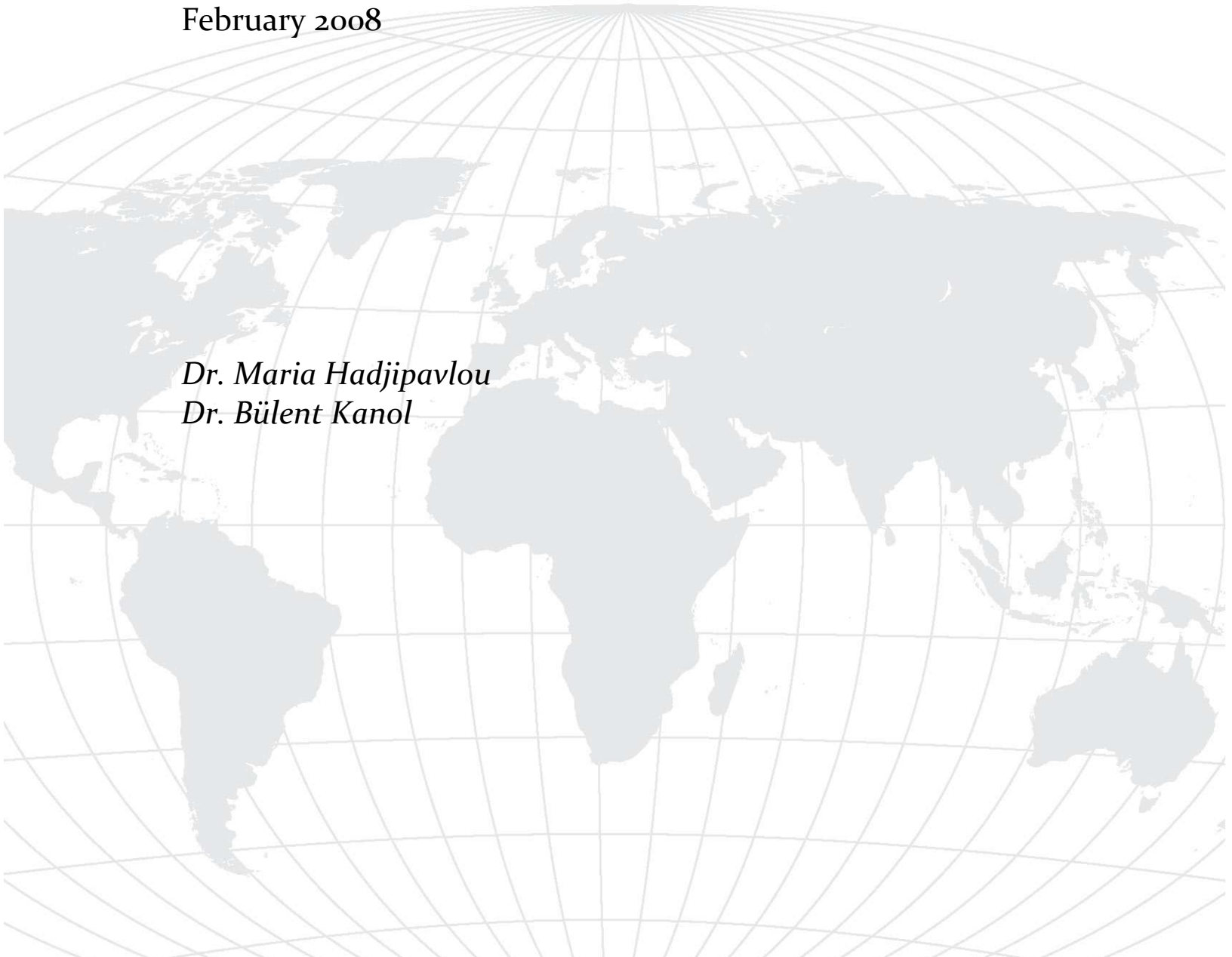
REFLECTING ON PEACE PRACTICE PROJECT

Cumulative Impact Case Study

The Impacts of Peacebuilding Work on the Cyprus Conflict

February 2008

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This document was developed as part of a collaborative learning project directed by CDA. It is part of a collection of documents that should be considered initial and partial findings of the project. These documents are written to allow for the identification of cross-cutting issues and themes across a range of situations. Each case represents the views and perspectives of a variety of people at the time when it was written.

These documents do not represent a final product of the project. While these documents may be cited, they remain working documents of a collaborative learning effort. Broad generalizations about the project's findings cannot be made from a single case.

CDA would like to acknowledge the generosity of the individuals and agencies involved in donating their time, experience and insights for these reports, and for their willingness to share their experiences.

Not all the documents written for any project have been made public. When people in the area where a report has been done have asked us to protect their anonymity and security, in deference to them and communities involved, we keep those documents private.

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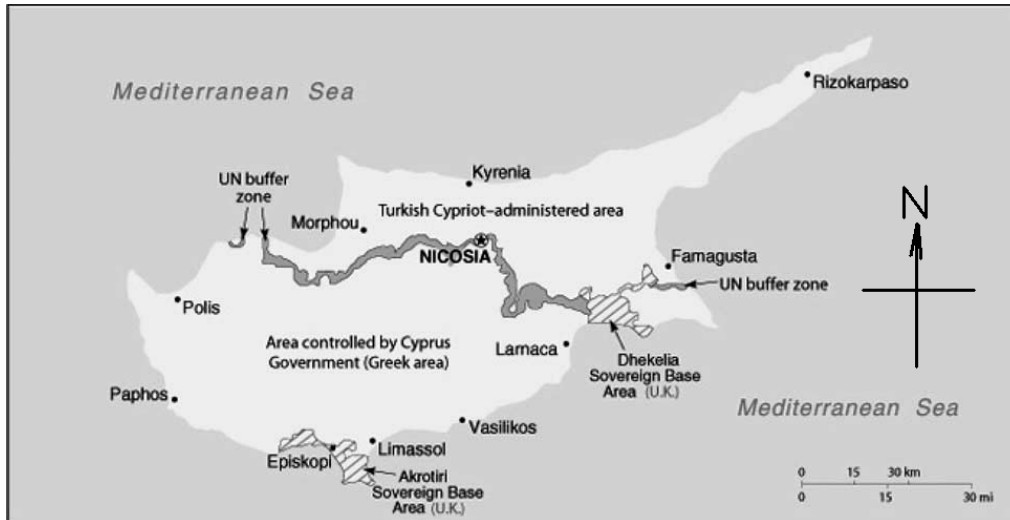
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MAP OF CYPRUS



INTRODUCTION AND METHODOLOGY

Background on the Reflecting on Peace Practice (RPP) project and Cumulative Impact Case Studies

From 1999 through early 2003, RPP engaged over two hundred agencies and many individuals who work on conflict around the world in a collaborative effort to learn how to improve the effectiveness of peace practice. The agencies included international peace and conflict resolution NGOs, as well as local organizations and groups working for peace in their countries. RPP conducted 26 case studies, and consulted with over 200 agencies and over 1,000 people to analyze peacebuilding experience. The findings of three years of analysis and consultation are presented in *Confronting War: Critical Lessons for Peace Practitioners*¹, which reviews recent peace practice, assesses elements that have been successful (or not) and why, and points to learning on how to improve effectiveness.

The evidence gathered by RPP suggests that although many people do, indeed, work at many levels, conducting good programs at each level, these initiatives do not automatically “add up” to peace! RPP found that peace programs that were effective in contributing to Peace Writ Large addressed key factors driving the conflict; many programs, however, did not relate their objectives to the driving forces of conflict, and consequently had little impact on the overall situation. Often, programs that had powerful impacts on participants’ attitudes and relationships did not lead to activity or changes that to affect a broader constituency of people, and programs working at the elite or grassroots levels were often not linked. Good programs had impact on the local situation, only to see this undermined by national regional developments. In addition, experience showed that peace programs were not linked to each other in ways that improved joint effectiveness, and efforts at coordination did not necessarily result in synergies and increased effectiveness.

While RPP’s findings to date have pointed to many factors that have *prevented* programs from “adding up” to have an impact on the overall conflict situation, they have yielded less evidence on what contributes to the “adding up” process. Key questions remaining include:

- How do multiple different peace efforts have cumulative impacts on a situation? What elements and/or processes determine whether there is a positive cumulative impact of multiple programs, reinforcing what others are doing as well as responding to changes in circumstances?

¹ Available at <http://www.cdainc.com/rpp/publications/confrontingwar/ConfrontingWar.pdf>

- How can we link micro (“peace writ little”) and macro (“peace writ large”) levels in programming decisions in order to improve the impacts of all programs on the broader peace?

RPP is addressing these questions in new case studies of contexts in which there has been progress towards peace, in some cases sustained and in others not. These cases look specifically at whether and how multiple peace efforts have cumulative positive impacts at particular moments, and how activities and successes at the community or local level and at the national level can be linked to provide sustainable changes and momentum toward peace. Over a period of year, RPP will conduct up to 15 cumulative case studies. The Project will gather experiences and reflections from these contexts, identify patterns and themes across locations, and highlight important findings concerning how practitioners and policy makers can improve cumulative impacts of their peacebuilding efforts.

Overview and methodology of case study on Cyprus

In order to assess the impact of peacebuilding activities in Cyprus we conducted a number of interviews with individuals from both Greek and Turkish Cypriot communities and with third parties involved in the Cyprus issue. All the interviews followed a structured pre-themed questionnaire. However, while the questions were asked in a standardised manner, respondent’s reactions and experiences were respected in the sense that interviewees could also expand their answers to include personal experiences and reflections. This allowed for a more in-depth exploration concerning participants’ relation to the issues of interest. Generally, this approach appears to have been successful. Most of the participants were interested and enjoyed talking about their personal experiences in relation to what they perceived to be of importance in the various projects and stakeholder issues.

In total, 40 people were interviewed between July and September 2008. Interviewees were working at various levels in their communities and as individuals in different organisations. Thirteen interviewees were from the Turkish Cypriot (TC) community and 16 were from the Greek Cypriot (GC) community. Of these, 5 Greek Cypriots and 2 Turkish Cypriots were female. The interviewees’ backgrounds included a wide selection of professions such as NGO activists and leaders, politicians, journalists, academics, trade unionists and business people. Some supported the Annan Plan, the most recent comprehensive settlement proposal by the United Nations, whereas others did not. Most of them had participated in conflict resolution and peacebuilding processes. In addition, we included analysis of interviews with 11 non-Cypriot third parties – both diplomats and conflict resolution trainers involved in the Cyprus issue.

The purpose of the interviews was to enable an analysis of individual reflections on their involvement in the peace process in Cyprus and to assess their impact. All the interviews were transcribed with the interviewees’ consent. Many of the interviewees are remarkable in that they have been a part of the most important citizen-based rapprochement/peacebuilding groups in Cyprus who worked for peace for decades. They created a process of dialogue and encounters which, since the events in 1974, has been unique in its intensity and extent.

Following an initial analysis, the participants' responses were compared and contrasted more thoroughly for their differences and commonalties. This enabled the final analysis to assess people's engagement with the complexity of the underlying issues, either through assistance received in the peacebuilding process or acts prohibiting it.

HISTORY OF THE CONFLICT

The geo-strategic location of Cyprus in the easternmost part of the Mediterranean has made it vulnerable to outside conquests and interference. Throughout history, whichever power dominated the region also controlled Cyprus. The island's archaeological landscape is full of monuments and symbols of these conquests of different periods which demonstrate the multiculturalism of the island.

The island is about 42 miles south of Turkey, 64 miles west of Syria, 240 miles north of Egypt and the Suez Canal, and 500 miles south-east of Greece. It has an area of 3,572 square miles, and currently the island is divided into the Greek Cypriot South (the Republic of Cyprus, which is internationally recognized) and the Turkish Cypriot North (the Turkish Republic of Northern Cyprus, which is not internationally recognized except by Turkey).

The Myceneans/Aegean Greeks who came and settled on the island in the 2nd millennium B.C. formed city-kingdoms on the Minoan model, and introduced the Greek language and culture as well as Greek political ideas and manner of administration (Tornarides, 1980). To this day the Greek Cypriots, especially the nationalists, selectively refer to this period to stress the Hellenic heritage and its continuity to the present and their belief that "the island has always been Greek." The Turkish Cypriots stress the three centuries of Ottoman presence (1571-1878) which determined the inter-ethnic character of the island, and the fact that the island belongs to Turkey.

Under Ottoman rule, the Greek Orthodox Church emerged as a powerful religious and political institution as the feudal system was abolished, and the land was redistributed among the Muslim and Christian peasants of the island. There is evidence that when the Ottomans conquered Cyprus they were treated with some kind of relief or even as liberators by the Cypriot peasants (Hill 1952, Salih 1968, Stephens 1966). Throughout most of this period, the Christians and the Muslims had peaceful, cooperative relations. This history, including jointly staged uprisings against the ruling classes, is used nowadays by many Greek Cypriots, especially left-wing, to highlight the fact that future co-existence is possible (Hill 1952, Kyrris 1976, Attalides, 1979). The Greek Cypriot right and nationalists tend to focus on the tragic events of 1821, when Archbishop Kyprianos and over five hundred priests and monks were hanged on the charge of instigating a Greek Cypriot uprising against the Ottomans. This narrative is also part of the official history textbooks (Papadakis 2005, Koumoulides, 1974), which stress the 'barbarity' of the Turkish intervention and invasion of Cyprus in 1974. (The Turkish Cypriot official narrative calls the 1974 intervention a "peace operation." (Volkan, 1978))

In 1878 Britain leased Cyprus from the ailing Ottoman Empire to be used as a base from which to protect the empire against the ambitions of Russia. The island became a British colony in 1925 and henceforth witnessed the gradual rise of Greek and Turkish Cypriot nationalisms. The late 1950s was a period of intense inter-ethnic mistrust, fears and violence. During the anti-colonial struggle led by EOKA (National Organization of Greek

Fighters) from 1955 to 1959, the Greeks of Cyprus fought the British for “*enosis*” (union) with “motherland” Greece and not for independence. According to Turkish Cypriot writers (Salih 1968, Nedjatigil, 1997), the Turkish Cypriot leadership expected the Greek fighters to eventually turn from their fight against the British towards the Turkish Cypriot community. In 1957 Turkish Cypriots formed the “Turkish Resistance Organization” (TMT) in an effort to counteract EOKA and started to fight for *taksim*, which meant partition of the island between Turkey and Greece.² Each community perceived the other’s organization of fighters as “terrorists.” Adding to the turmoil, during this period the British politicized intra-communal differences as a tool to serve their colonial interests in the Middle East, especially after the loss of the Suez Canal (Pollis, 1998).

A compromise settlement, which excluded both *enosis* and *taksim*, was eventually worked out by the three outside stakeholders—Greece, Turkey and Britain—in what became known as the Zurich and London Agreements, creating in 1960 the ‘reluctant’ Republic of Cyprus (Xydis, 1973). The Zurich and London Agreements established the basic structure for the new and independent Republic of Cyprus. The imposed accommodation provided for a partnership republic but with a complicated system of veto powers allocated to both the President and the Vice President. The Cyprus Constitution gave the rights to each community to elect their own representations at a ratio of 70:30, and vote separately for the President, who was to be a Greek Cypriot, and the Vice President who was to be a Turkish Cypriot. A national parliament with two communal chambers was established to deal with issues such as education, culture and religion. Turkish Cypriots, who were 18% of the population, would be represented at a level of 30% to 40% in the cabinet, public service, police and army. Each community would have a veto over legislations touching on its vital interests.³

The Constitution was backed by three treaties. The first established two sovereign British bases which later were used during the cold war as NATO bases (the Treaty of Establishment). Under the second, a Treaty of Guarantee signed by Britain, Greece and Turkey, the three guarantor powers of the island’s independence and territorial integrity undertook to ensure respect for the Constitution of Cyprus and the state of affairs created. The three powers thereby granted themselves the right, in the event of a breach, to take action with the sole aim of re-establishing the state of affairs created by the Treaty (Turkey invoked this treaty in July 1974 when it intervened militarily in Cyprus). This provision in effect institutionalized outside intervention and limited the independence of Cyprus and the state’s flexibility to introduce adjustments to the constitutional structure when needed. The Turkish Cypriots, however, regarded (and still regard) this treaty as a safeguard to their security. The third Treaty given to the Cypriots was the Treaty of Alliance signed between Cyprus, Greece and Turkey entitling the two ‘motherlands’ to

² Maronites and Armenians and Latins remained largely indifferent during this historical period or opted to side with the majority which were the Greek Cypriots.

³ When Cyprus obtained its independence in 1960 the Turkish Cypriots comprised 18 percent of the population and the Greeks 80 percent. The demographics were cited as 82 % Greek Cypriots since the 1960 constitution forced the Armenian, Maronite and Latin groups constituting the 2% of the population to choose one of the two major communities to belong to. They all chose the Greek Cypriot community.

station military contingents on the island on a ratio of 60:40, specifically, 950 Greeks and 650 Turks.

With all these provisions there was little space left for the Cypriots to develop a Cypriot consciousness and a loyalty to the state and its symbols, as well as to foster common interests and needs. Independence was interpreted by each community in terms of their status as majority or minority and their separate nationalistic aspirations, which continued, even after the Cyprus republic was established (Attalides 1979; Hadjipavlou 1987). Thus, the Greek Cypriots who fought for *enosis* saw independence as an interim stage until favourable conditions would allow for *enosis*, while the Turkish Cypriots saw it as a stage before realizing their goal of partition. These attitudes and positions were clearly indicative of the antagonism already rooted in the two distinct national identities.

In addition, the constitutional arrangements were divisive. The Constitution of 1960 lacked any integrative institutions which could have developed inter-communal cooperation, a common vision and loyalty to the state as well as a sense of Cypriot citizenship. Educational and cultural affairs were run by separate communal chambers, and two separate educational systems were closely connected to each community's 'motherland.' Thus, the Greek and Turkish identities were stressed much more than the common civil identity of Cypriotness (Hadjipavlou 2002, Kyriakides, 1968).

By 1963, the Republic of Cyprus was mired in a constitutional crisis. In November 1963, President Makarios proposed a series of constitutional amendments that would have eliminated a number of veto powers and, in his view, made the constitution more workable. However, past mistrust (emerging, for example, from Makarios' statements in 1962 regarding his views of the new republic as a stepping stone to *enosis*) led the Turkish Cypriot leadership to fear that the amendments were intended to eliminate Turkish Cypriots' powers to co-govern the Republic, and to achieve *enosis*. Turkey also rejected these amendments. As a result, inter-communal fighting began in December 1963 in what became known as the "Bloody Noel" trauma for Turkish Cypriots. On December 23, The Turkish Cypriot Vice President, Dr. Fazıl Küçük, declared that "the Constitution is dead," and all Cypriot Turks, from the lowest civil servants to ministers and Vice-President Küçük withdrew from the government" (*New York Herald Tribune*, Dec. 23, 1963). The Greek Cypriot narrative called this event "a Turkish Cypriot insurrection to promote partition," while Turkish Cypriots described this process as an act of their expulsion from the government and the state apparatus of the Republic of Cyprus.

Strong accusations as to who was to be blamed for the outbreak of violence followed. Hundreds of people were killed from each side, deepening the mistrust and fears even further. To prevent a Turkish military intervention in 1964 and Cyprus becoming a 'Russian Mediterranean satellite,' the United States proposed the 'Acheson Plan.' The Plan, which essentially envisioned the partition of the island between Greece and Turkey, was rejected by the Greek Cypriots and Greece and later by Turkey (Patrick, 1976).

In March 1964, President Makarios took the issue before the United Nations. The UN Security Council reached a decision (Resolution 186) authorizing a UN peacekeeping

force (UNFICYP) and a good offices mission. In order to be able to send UN peacekeeping troops to the island, the UN recognized the Government of Cyprus, then run only by Greek Cypriots, as the legal government under “the doctrine of necessity.” This meant that the Greek Cypriot-dominated government would act as the legal entity until a viable solution could be found for the restoration of the constitution and a legitimate government comprising of both Greek and Turkish Cypriots.

The inter-communal fighting also resulted in the creation of a “Green line” – a dividing line in the capital Nicosia to keep the two warring factions apart – and the displacement of approximately 30,000 Turkish Cypriots to enclaves established for their security in the major cities of the island (Volkan 1978). The Turkish Cypriot leadership instituted its own administration and services, established its own laws, police and economic policies (Attalides, 1979), and gradually became more and more dependent on Turkey. The period following 1963 was a time of unequal social and economic development, another factor that tore the two communities further apart. Greek Cypriots experienced economic prosperity and modernization, whereas Turkish Cypriots entered a period of economic and cultural dependency on Turkey, which they regarded as their “protector” from Greek Cypriot domination. The Turkish Cypriot community felt like second-class citizens, as they were excluded from all state privileges that the Greek Cypriots enjoyed.

1967 saw renewed violence led by General Grivas (and supported by the new military dictatorship in Greece) against Turkish Cypriots from the village of Kofinou (Kofunye). Turkey threatened to intervene militarily. Greece agreed under pressure from the UN and the U.S. to recall General Grivas and the Greek military forces. Under the accord, Turkish Cypriots were allowed to move freely on the island. Negotiations for the restoration of the constitution started between the two main interlocutors, Glafkos Clerides and Rauf Denktash,⁴ continuing until 1974. According to Clerides, the parties nearly came to an agreement in 1973, when President Makarios turned down an accord reached by the two interlocutors. But the events of 1974 destroyed any prospect of an agreement. On July 15, 1974, the Greek Cypriot underground terrorist organization, EOKA-B, with the support of the Greek junta (which in turn was then supported by the American administration), staged a coup d’état against the Makarios government in order to bring about *enosis* with Greece (Stern, 1975). The coup failed, and Makarios survived. However, it was interpreted as a violation of the Treaty of Guarantee, justifying Turkish military intervention on July 20. This initial Turkish military intervention was internationally viewed with understanding. However, by the time of a second round of talks in Geneva to end the violence, and following the restoration of democratic government in Greece, a second military attack on August 14, 1974 (in which Turkish troops occupied 37% of the island) was met with less sympathy. Turkey still maintains about 35,000 troops on the northern part of the island, an issue that continues to be a significant source of tension. On the one hand, Greek Cypriots view Turkey as a cause of their insecurity due to its proximity, size and ongoing occupation of 37% of the

⁴ The free movement of Greek Cypriots to some of the Turkish Cypriot areas was restricted by the Turkish military, which did not lift road blocks. This act was perceived by some as a matter of security, but by others as an act intended to partition the island.

republic's territory. Turkish Cypriots, by contrast, consider Turkey as indispensable to their security and are reluctant to demilitarize completely.

The Turkish action transformed the Cyprus situation by dividing the island for the first time both geographically and ethnically. This displaced most Greek Cypriots to the South and Turkish Cypriots northwards. Whereas the Turkish Cypriots bore the heavier cost in terms of casualties, missing and displacement between 1963-1967, Greek Cypriots in 1974 suffered most in terms of people killed and missing, other economic and social costs, and in particular the dislocation of one third of its total population of 600,000. The militarization of the island began, and an embargo on communication and inter-communal contacts was imposed. New generations of Cypriots were brought up on each side of the divide without knowing each other. Misperceptions, stereotyping, 'chosen traumas', selective histories and hatred was institutionalized in the education, the media and the official narratives on both sides.

A series of negotiations began soon after 1974 between the leaders of the two communities under the good offices of the UN Secretary General. In 1977 the first high level agreement between the two leaders, Makarios and Denktash, was signed, outlining the basic principles for a settlement. It provided for a bi-communal federation and included discussion of the three freedoms (freedom of settlement, freedom of property ownership and freedom of movement), an important issue for Greek Cypriots.⁵ In 1979 another high level agreement between Denktash and Spiros Kyprianou, Makarios' successor as President, was signed. This agreement reiterated the 1977 agreements and indicated that the new bi-communal federal republic was to be bi-zonal. It also offered a series of confidence-building measures, including prospective demilitarization of the island, respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms and a commitment to refrain from destabilizing actions.⁶ These agreements and many other previous UN documents would eventually become the basis for a new comprehensive settlement proposal in 2002 known as the 'Annan Plan'.

Despite this progress, it was quickly clear that the parties interpreted these guidelines very differently. The Turkish Cypriots stressed a loose decentralized federation similar to

⁵ The 1977 agreement consisted of four guidelines:

- (1) We are seeking an independent, non-aligned, bi-communal federal republic.
- (2) The territory under the administration of each community should be discussed in the light of economic viability or productivity and land-ownership.
- (3) Questions of principles like freedom of movement, freedom of settlement, the right of property and other specific matters are open for discussion taking into consideration the fundamental basis of a bi-communal federal system and certain practical difficulties which may arise for the Turkish Cypriot community.
- (4) The powers and functions of the central federal government will be such as to safeguard the unity of the country having regard to the bi-communal character of the State.

High Level Agreement of 1977, available at [http://www02.mfa.gov.cy/mfa/mfa.nsf/73819879AFA2E8AAC2256B7B004DA64B/\\$FILE/High%20Level%20Agreement%201977.doc](http://www02.mfa.gov.cy/mfa/mfa.nsf/73819879AFA2E8AAC2256B7B004DA64B/$FILE/High%20Level%20Agreement%201977.doc).

⁶ The word "bi-zonal" does not actually appear in either agreement, but is implicit and has been accepted internationally as the basis for the bi-communal federation. High Level Agreement of 1979, available at [http://www02.mfa.gov.cy/mfa/mfa.nsf/5408FB462E61E7BDC2256B7B004DACA4/\\$FILE/High%20Level%20Agreement%201979.doc](http://www02.mfa.gov.cy/mfa/mfa.nsf/5408FB462E61E7BDC2256B7B004DACA4/$FILE/High%20Level%20Agreement%201979.doc).

a confederation, whereas the Greek Cypriots emphasized a strong centralized federation that resembled a unitary state. The situation also evolved, introducing new issues and difficulties in the negotiation process. In 1983 the Turkish Cypriot leadership, with the full support of Ankara, unilaterally declared independence. The Turkish Republic of Northern Cyprus (TRNC) failed to gain recognition by any other country but Turkey, which meant international isolation of the Turkish Cypriot community and increased dependency on Turkey both economically and politically. Greek Cypriot characterization of the TRNC as an “illegal” or “so-called” state led to efforts to prevent any implicit recognition of Turkish Cypriot sovereignty, including a *de facto* economic embargo on the Turkish Cypriot community that was backed by a decision by the European Court of Justice in 1994.⁷ This isolation generated enormous resentment in the Turkish Cypriot community, and contributed to economic stagnation in the North while the Greek Cypriot economy boomed during the 1980s and 1990s.

In addition, over the years the demographic composition in the North has changed with the influx of people from poor regions of Turkey, creating what has become known as ‘the settler problem.’ A recent census in the North established that around 46,769 settlers came in the 1970s and gained Turkish Cypriot citizenship. Another 70,525 settled in Cyprus but still hold Turkish (not Turkish Cypriot) citizenship (including students and temporary workers). At the same time, thousands of Turkish Cypriots emigrated to other countries, mainly for economic reasons and in search of a better future. The Turkish Cypriot leftist and opposition press often spoke about the Turkish Cypriot community becoming almost a minority vis-à-vis the “settler problem.”

The most recent initiative, led by UN Special Representative of the Secretary General Alvaro De Soto, took place in the shadow of Cyprus’ accession to the European Union and with European Union support (Bryant 2004a, 2004b, Tocci 2004, Joseph 1997). After start-and-stop negotiations from 1999-2001, in November 2002 the UN presented to the leaders of the two communities a proposal known as the “Annan Plan.” This comprehensive plan, comprising 182 pages of main articles and another 9,000 pages of annexes, stipulated a solution within a federal framework with simultaneous inclusion of the whole of Cyprus within the EU. The plan was revised several times in 2002 and 2003, but in April 2004 the final version was defeated in simultaneous referenda, with Greek Cypriots voting “No” by 76 % and 67% of the Turkish Cypriots voting “Yes,” with the support of Turkish Prime Minister Recep Tayyip Erdogan.

The Turkish Cypriot “Yes” vote represented a dramatic reversal of position, as Rauf Denktash had rejected the third draft of the Plan as late as March 2003. Prior to the referenda, mass mobilization and public demonstrations led by the left and the centre-left, the youth, unions and business and NGOs in the North all supported a change of leadership and of the status quo. This ‘revolution from below,’ with the support and participation of many peace builders, forced the Turkish military and the Turkish Cypriot leadership to open some check-points across the Green Line, allowing thousands of people to cross to the other sides. The opening of gates was a new era for the Turkish and

⁷ The European Court decision prohibited EU member states from accepting agricultural products from Northern Cyprus without phyto-sanitary certificates issued by the Greek Cypriot-controlled Republic.

Greek Cypriots. Turkish Cypriots were able to claim back their rights to the citizenship of the Republic of Cyprus (and later EU citizenship), and Greek Cypriots were able to move freely around the island for the first time since 1963, visiting their old property and homes as well as re-uniting with former co-villagers. In late 2003, elections brought a change in leadership amongst the Turkish Cypriots, as Mehmet Ali Talat of the leftist Turkish Republican Party defeated Rauf Denktaş, and brought the pro-solution forces to power in the North.

On the Greek Cypriot side, however, Tassos Papadopoulos of the centre-right DIKO party became President in early 2004, backed by the communist party AKEL and the socialist party EDEK. He promoted the view that the Annan Plan was pro-Turkish, and that it did not respond to the Greek Cypriots' need for security and human rights. In his view, accepting the plan would have meant the dissolution of the Cyprus Republic without any guarantee that the agreement could have been implemented, given Turkey's untrustworthiness. These different and competing interpretations of the Plan became manifest in the referenda results on April 24, 2004. After the Annan Plan's defeat, some Greek Cypriot politicians referred to the 'Europeanization' of the conflict, expecting a better deal once Cyprus became an EU member.

This failure of the referenda marked a new turning point in the recent history of Cyprus. A week after the referenda, on May 1, 2004 the Republic of Cyprus became a member of the European Union without a solution. Yet again, the lack of trust and a shared vision led to competing results and the deepening of divisions. The shared EU agenda bi-communal peace builders had promoted over the years did not prove strong enough to overcome collective mistrust, fears, leadership intransigence and historical grievances.

The "crossings" to and from the North and South helped smooth out many old stereotypes and misperceptions, while at the same time creating new and different relationships. However, the post-referenda political climate was mainly one of renewed mistrust and feelings of betrayal, especially among the Turkish Cypriot left (Turkish Republican Party). They had expected the Greek Cypriot left (AKEL) to vote "Yes" to the Plan, but AKEL instead had characterized it as an "Anglo-American" plan which did not serve the interests of the Cypriot people.

The adversarial discourse at the official level created frustration among the pro-solution people in both communities, and weakened engagement in the rapprochement and peacebuilding work. A recycling of the conflict culture re-emerged, with continuing consequences to the present time. Fewer people from both communities crossed to the other side. Many politicians, both left and right, as well as peace builders express fears that the partition of the island is deepening. Adding to the tension and complicating future negotiations, many foreign and local developers started building on Greek Cypriot land in the north after the referenda and selling it to foreigners. By 2006, the North was experiencing an economic boom. Greek Cypriot refugees and their organizations protested strongly and demanded the cessation of this activity. In turn, some Turkish Cypriots who wanted to regain the right to their property in the South were rejected by the Greek Cypriot establishment on the grounds that they were not living in the South.

Some others had their properties confiscated for the “public good” without any compensation.

The latest UN initiative was a meeting between the leaders of the two communities under UN auspices in July 2006, in which both leaders agreed to the establishment of technical committees to discuss both day-to-day issues and issues of substance. International attention has focused on how to help the Turkish Cypriots get out of their political and economic isolation, but these efforts have been frequently blocked by the Greek Cypriot government. As of February 2008, no progress had yet been achieved, and the impasse at the macro level continued apart from the EU initiative to transfer 259 million Euros in aid to the Turkish Cypriot community. Much of this funding will go to building infrastructures, institutional support and promoting bi-communal peacebuilding projects. However, the victory of AKEL leader Dimitris Christofias in the second round of presidential elections in the Republic of Cyprus on February 24, 2008 brings the possibility of change in the Greek Cypriot attitude, and perhaps the restart of negotiations and the promotion of closer contacts with the Turkish Cypriot leadership.

CIVIL SOCIETY PEACEBUILDING ACTIVITIES IN CYPRUS

In this section we shall highlight the peacebuilding activities that have taken place on the island from the late 1970s to the present day. Most of these activities have been funded and run by outside third parties. The main theories of change upon which these activities operated have been Gordon Allport's (1956) 'contact theory', Herbert Kelman's assumptions about the social psychological aspects of international conflicts,⁸ the humanistic approach to mediation and Roger Fisher's 'win-win' theory of negotiations.⁹ Communication theories have also been adopted.

Since the late 1970s, many conflict resolution workshops have taken place to bring together members of both communities in Cyprus to learn about one another, share experiences and build greater cooperation and trust, in an effort to make progress towards a solution. These workshops started slowly in the beginning, supported and driven mostly by the international community. But through the 1980s and especially towards the end of the 90s, they gained momentum and flourished. Bi-communal groups were formed around many issues and skills training. By the late 1990s a group of thirty citizens from both communities were trained as conflict resolution trainers and thus took ownership of the work. After the opening of the checkpoint in 2003, bi-communal projects lost momentum. However, there are still many efforts today supported by the international community as well as Cypriots that are continuing as we shall see below. The following is a sampling of some of the conflict resolution workshops, their agendas and results. (A more detailed list is provided in Appendix C).

'Problem-solving workshops' in Cyprus began in 1966, after the first inter-communal violence and the call from the international community for talks between the leaders of the two communities. The 'father' of the approach, John Burton, and his colleagues in London offered a five-day workshop in controlled communication that brought together high level representatives from the two communities in a safe academic environment to think jointly and produce new ideas that would have then helped restart the official dialogue process. The result was positive, and official talks did resume between the two sides. In 1973, an informal seminar was held with political leaders of the two communities in Rome facilitated by Prof. Leonard Doob. After that successful meeting, Doob (1974)¹⁰ made offers of a workshop in Cyprus in the summer of 1974. Due to the tragic events of that period, it could not be conducted. He did succeed, however, in holding similar workshops in 1979 and 1984. He termed these workshops 'psychological sensitivity' trainings; they focused mostly on helping participants understand one another better and build mutual trust.

After Doob's initial success, more international third parties conducted workshops in the 80s. In 1984, Professor Herbert Kelman conducted a bi-communal workshop on interactive problem solving sponsored by the Middle Eastern Affairs Institute in Washington D.C. and held in Cambridge, Mass. The main premise of this unofficial

⁸ See Kelman, 1997.

⁹ See Fisher, Ury and Patton, 1991.

¹⁰ See Doob, 1974.

process is that international conflict does not concern only the states and official diplomacy but the societies and the citizens as well. Therefore, citizens have a role to play in the unofficial process. Citizens from the conflicting parties are brought together in a safe unofficial environment to engage in dialogue in which each party presents their fears, concerns and hopes and a deeper understanding of the other (the perceived enemy) evolves. The process then invites each side to identify the obstacles to peace and then generate new ideas and projects as to how to overcome these obstacles. Sometimes a joint report or a policy paper is produced which is then circulated to interested parties in both communities and also to third parties involved in the conflict.

From 1988 to 1993, Professor Ron Fisher held several conflict analysis and *problem solving workshops* with an extensive focus on the role of education in peacebuilding. In 1989, the *British Friends of Cyprus Committee* also held a dialogue meeting amongst high level educators from the Turkish and Greek Cypriot communities to discuss the role of education (primary, secondary and tertiary) in a future federal bi-communal Cyprus. This meeting was held at Ledra Palace, an old hotel that remained in the buffer zone after 1974 and where almost all bi-communal activities were held until 1997. The participants in this meeting produced a report and a press release which were sent to politicians. The report stressed the importance of education in peace talks and invited the leaders to include the issue of education in their agenda.

In 1989 *The German Institute for Education, Democracy and Preservation of the Environment* invited 20 Cypriots – ten from each community – to a four-day conference in Berlin to engage in open dialogue on the current political situation and how it affected inter-communal relations, and to reflect on their role as citizens. Follow-up meetings were held at the Ledra Palace. Institutionalizing into the first bi-communal social and political movement, ‘*Citizens Joint Movement for a Federal and Democratic Cyprus.*’ in 1990, this group met without a third party mediator, coordinated bi-communal efforts with UNFICYP, and helped select participants for the ongoing workshops. Cypriots began to take ownership of these workshops and create groups and organizations to address specific issues. Its goal was to mobilize ordinary citizens in the unofficial peacebuilding process, in the belief that this would put pressure for the resumption of official negotiations. The group hosted many public discussions to share ideas, goals and positions of political parties in both communities. It hosted diplomats at Ledra Palace to discuss federalism, in addition to meetings held to jointly study federation and how it was understood in each community, as well as cultural events and intra-communal activities and discussions aimed at changing perceptions and attitudes.¹¹

The 1990s saw a continuation of workshops by international third parties as well as the beginning of Cypriot-initiated organizations. In 1991, the Peace Centre Cyprus was officially registered as an NGO in the South. The Centre (www.peace.org.cy) is dedicated to peace education, dialogue among the communities, trainings in conflict resolution and empowerment of youth in both mono- and bi-communal activities. Its formation was strongly supported by the international community. In July 1991, Louise Diamond, a

¹¹ For more details about this process see Hadjipavlou -Trigeorgis, 1993.

conflict resolution specialist from the *Institute for Multi-Track Diplomacy* in the United States, visited Cyprus at the invitation of members of the newly formed Peace Centre and began offering workshops on conflict resolution. Initially, one workshop was held in each community. In October 1992 a joint steering committee was formed for the purpose of promoting the conflict resolution efforts in Cyprus and helping third party trainers in their work on Cyprus. By July 1993, Diamond was able to convene a workshop on conflict resolution skills and communication in Oxford, England for a group of ten Greek Cypriots and ten Turkish Cypriots. Among the participants in that workshop were the son of the Turkish Cypriot leader and the daughter of the Greek Cypriot leader. This initiative was leaked and was immediately politicized by the mass media in both communities, who demonized the “Oxford Group,” as it was called, as a pawn of the interests of the Anglo-Americans. This gave the group the opportunity to promote conflict resolution. They held a press conference to explain what conflict resolution and the Oxford workshop were about, and subsequently wrote articles and held public talks in various cities informing the people about the field of conflict resolution and its relevance to Cyprus.

After that workshop, a series of workshops in conflict resolution were held in the summer of 1994, organised by the *Cyprus Fulbright Commission* (CFC) and conducted by the Cyprus Consortium, a group of American organizations that consisted of *Institute for Multi-Track Diplomacy* (IMTD), the *Conflict Management Group* (CMG) and the *National Training Laboratory* (NTL). The Cyprus Consortium continued to offer trainings in 1995-96 and 1997. These workshops included communication skills, negotiation and mediation, problem solving and project design processes. They brought Greek and Turkish Cypriots together in a neutral space (outside of Cyprus or in the buffer zone) to learn and practice skills of communication, conflict analysis, and cooperative problem-solving and create new possibilities for dealing with the conflict. The workshops were directed to a wide range of sectors: ordinary citizens, professionals, youth, women, educators, and others. Significantly, political leaders from all the major parties on both sides were also targeted for the first time, in order to enhance the legitimacy of bi-communal conflict resolution efforts. From these trainings a core group of Cypriot trainers emerged who would facilitate workshops in their respective communities.

In addition, the Fulbright scholar initiative was introduced by the Cyprus Fulbright Commission and at the request of the Peace Centre, the aim being to have a scholar-practitioner stay on the island for a longer period and work with local bi-communal groups. One of these scholars was Prof. Ben Broome, an experienced third party practitioner who worked in Cyprus from 1994 to 1996. He offered seminars, trainings and workshops in conflict resolution and bi-communal activities to many groups, including youth, business leaders, women’s groups, young political leaders and educationalists. Using a new methodology, Interactive Management (IM), from October 1994 – June 1995, he also worked with participants from the summer of 1994 conflict resolution workshops and others to develop a strategy for the peacebuilding efforts in Cyprus. The group met weekly and occasionally on weekends, initially mono-communally, because at that time the political situation did not permit bi-communal meetings, as from the fall of 1994 until February 1995, Turkish Cypriot participants were denied permits to cross to the buffer zone. The products of this group was the formulation

of a joint vision that could act as a guide for peacebuilding activities at the citizens' level, a system analysis of the obstacles to peacebuilding efforts in Cyprus, and a plan of activities that would guide their work over the following two or three years. Moreover, they prepared fifteen projects including workshops, presentations, training programs and other events and staged an agora/bazaar where individuals were invited to sign up for several bi-communal projects. Nearly 300 individuals signed up and became involved in twelve Cypriot-led bi-communal projects.¹²

One of the most inspiring projects that emerged from the 1995 workshops was an initiative called the *Youth Encounters for Peace* (YEP), which brought together numerous groups of young people ranging from the ages sixteen to nineteen around common experiences or interests to create trust, knowledge of the other and a sense of possibility for peace. YEP started in July 1997, with two-day gatherings that brought together thirty Greek Cypriots and thirty Turkish Cypriots. Between 1997 and 2002, more than eleven additional groups were formed, bringing together hundreds of young people. The groups sponsored musical concerts, festivals, dances, tree-planting and workshops. They also developed a co-villagers project in Pyla, which in July 1999 brought together Cypriots who had lived in the same village before 1974. As a result of this event, Cypriots who had not seen each other for twenty-five to thirty-five years were re-united at emotional gatherings that included the exchange of food, drink, photos and in some cases treasured personal items that had been left behind in 1974 and saved by neighbours or the present residents of their houses.¹³

Another Fulbright Scholar, Prof. Marco Turk, later offered a series of mediation training programs which started in 1997 and continued through 1999 using the “humanistic approach.”¹⁴ These mediation trainings included both bi-communal and mono-communal groups and consisted of programs ranging from fifteen to forty hours of instruction, exercises and role playing. These workshops were offered to bi-communal citizens groups, teachers, psychiatric nurses, a Turkish Cypriot women’s group and mental healthcare professionals. When the bi-communal activities were interrupted for political reasons in December 1997, Turk took several bi-communal groups outside Cyprus for training in mediation and negotiation. One such group was the “Oslo group,” which produced an important report on all aspects of the conflict and proposed joint ideas for solutions.

By 1997, there was a flourishing of special bi-communal interest groups, including women’s groups, students, young environmentalists, businessmen, educators, academics, citizens groups, a choir, artists, management groups, HADE magazine (a bi-communal magazine featuring articles written by the members of both communities about the peacebuilding efforts in Cyprus including stories about bi-communal groups, specific bi-

¹² For details see Broome, 2005, and Hadjipavlou, 1998.

¹³ Another youth movement, Youth Promoting Peace, was started in 2001 with similar goals and linkages to YEP. This movement has organized tree-planting in Pyla and youth conferences on rapprochement, among many activities.

¹⁴ See http://rjp.umn.edu/Copy_of_Restorative_Justice_Principles-43ea0f56df14c.html (accessed May 15, 2008) for further information on this approach to mediation.

communal events and the experiences of individuals who have visited places on ‘the other side’ for the first time), co-villager groups, lawyers and accountants groups, internet groups, federation study groups and EU study groups. Then, in 1997, in response to the EU’s Luxembourg decision giving the green light for the start of accession negotiations with Cyprus, TC authorities closed the checkpoints and forbade bi-communal activities. Some activities did continue, with groups meeting in Pyla, a bi-communal village on the ceasefire line, despite the ‘ban’ on bi-communal activities and harassment of participants.

Due to the difficulties in crossing during 1997, *Tech 4 Peace*, a Cypriot civil society organization dedicated to improving communication and trust building among youth in Cyprus, established a website, www.tech4peace.org in 1998. This website was the first peace portal in Cyprus, funded by UNOPS. It aimed to bring the Greek Cypriot and Turkish Cypriot communities of the island closer together by creating a virtual society for those interested to work together on collaborative projects and stay informed on developments. It provided links to all bi-communal groups, as well as to major international organisations active in the field of peace and organisations that provide funding and support for such efforts. Mailing lists and directories of members, a calendar of upcoming events, interactive magazine, on-line polls, and a library of resources were also offered.

In 1998, asked by US State Department to create a program for Cypriot youth, *Seeds of Peace* began its project in Cyprus. *The Seeds of Peace* group, supported by the Cyprus Fulbright Commission and staffed with facilitator-trainers that had been trained by the Cyprus Consortium and Fulbright scholars on the island, brought together Cypriot youth in the United States for a summer camp at which they ate and slept in the same premises and had the opportunity to discover their common heritage. During the camp, the Cypriot facilitators conducted conflict resolution workshops for the youth, taking them, for example on a “walk through history,” in which important dates in Cypriot history were marked. This exercise brought up contentious issues which gradually moved the youth beyond recriminations and toward active listening and exploration of identity and stereotypes, leading to mutual understanding and trust. After their camp experience, the youth returned to Cyprus and met daily on the internet to continue their debates. They also participated in follow up workshops to enhance their coexistence training. The program graduated up to one hundred youth from both communities.

After the opening of the checkpoints in 2003, and the 2004 referenda on the Annan Plan, the momentum waned for the structured bi-communal meetings sponsored by international or Cypriot organizations. A new need arose to revisit the agenda and goals of the peacebuilding process in Cyprus. At the present time, there are several bi-communal projects undertaken by Cypriot organizations, many (though not all) of which are funded through UNDP or the US Embassy. Youth projects continue to be a major focus, and are among the few still focused on dialogue and conflict resolution. ‘*Let’s Unite our Beautiful Island*’ is a youth group that very recently came together on FaceBook, and held its first meeting between youth, parents and family on 6 August 2007 to discuss the present situation and the need to encourage more dialogue and cooperation. ‘*Provision of Multicultural Youth Camp Training*’ by International Child Development

Initiatives is another effort that seeks to promote the organisation of successful youth camps by organizing multicultural youth camp trainings, establishing a network and developing camp models. ‘*Playing for Peace*,’ aims to develop youth leaders, deliver training in both single-community and inter-communal settings and help children foster trust and relationships using the game of basketball. And the ‘*Youth Dialogue Project*’ seeks to engage youth between 15 and 24 years of age in both communities in exploring jointly the dynamics that shape their attitudes and aspirations. Using youth-designed surveys and input from experts in youth matters, the project aims to produce a quality analytical and authoritative report on the state of young people in Cyprus, focusing on their challenges, attitudes and aspirations for the future, as well as a Cyprus Youth Charter to be used as an advocacy tool with political leaders and decision-makers in both communities. UNDP also ran six youth camps in 2006 with over 260 youths participating and 8 more camps in 2007, and AMIDEAST supported additional youth camps for college-age as well as high school students.¹⁵ These camps provide a venue for youth to explore their activities of interest in a bi-communal setting. Surveys have shown that youth from these camps maintain cross-communal contact long after the camps, and have higher levels of trust for each other and a stronger belief that they have things in common.

Initiatives to integrate tolerance and respect for different cultures into the education system on both sides have also been undertaken. *The Association for Historical Dialogue and Research* conducts projects on education and history teaching. It coordinates with POST on the project *Education for Peace*, which has analyzed the revision of history textbooks in the Turkish Cypriot Community. They are now working to develop trainings for teachers so they are more prepared to teach the new history textbooks. A similar project, the *History Teacher Training Project* by the Centre for Democracy and Reconciliation in Southeast Europe (CDRSEE), aims to enhance the understanding of multi-perspective history teaching by providing training and supplementary textbooks to teachers. In the schools, an anti-racism, anti-nationalist group was formed in reaction to events at the English School,¹⁶ in which Turkish Cypriot students were physically attacked by Greek Cypriots from the outside. Another of these projects is *Conflict Resolution & Peace Education (CRE/PE)* by the Mediation Association, KAYAD, Peace Centre, and British Council, which aims to promote awareness of CRE/PE throughout Cyprus, and train 1,600 Turkish Cypriot elementary school teachers to teach this subject.

¹⁵ For example, the ‘Bold Leaders’ program, supported by AMIDEAST, seeks to increase strengthen communication and conflict transformation skills of youth, and increase inter-cultural understanding of Greek and Turkish Cypriot youth and support their leadership in promoting reconciliation. See <http://www.cyber-reality.com/BoldLeaders/whatisit.aspx> (accessed April 22, 2008). The Cyprus America Scholarship Program (CASP), starting in the mid 1990s, began holding two week intensive summer programs at the School for International Training in Vermont for college aged participants. This initiative is ongoing, and provides students with a combination of skills training, dialogue sessions, outdoors teambuilding activities, social and recreational activities and created an environment which built inter-communal confidence from living together. See http://www.amideast.org/programs_services/exchange_programs/casp/bi_communal_programs.htm (accessed April 22, 2008).

¹⁶ The English School is a private, English-language (British) secondary school in Nicosia that served all the communities in Cyprus until 1974, when the student body became primarily Greek Cypriot. After the opening of the checkpoints in 2003, the school re-integrated Turkish Cypriots into the student and faculty bodies.

The trained teachers will then introduce new skills, such as responsibility, tolerance, integrity, self-esteem, conflict resolution, cultural and interpersonal competence, restraint, decision-making and vision-building.

Bi-communal women's initiatives, environmental projects and efforts to preserve historical or cultural structures are also among the activities being conducted. For example, *Hands Across the Divide (HAD)* is an independent women's organization which is promoting a gendered analysis of the conflict, supports reunification of the island and gender mainstreaming in all policies and institutions as well as promoting the elimination of all forms of violence. Another organization works to revive the old city of Varosha¹⁷ and Famagusta and it works alongside with New Cyprus Party (YKP), German Cypriot Forum, Friends of Nature Cyprus, TC Teachers Trade Union (KTOS), Cyprus Art Association (KSD), Rights and Freedoms Association. They all support the need to find a solution for Famagusta.

One unique post-referenda activity was in the area of economics. With sponsorship from British High Commission a group of economists from both sides supported by international experts and coordinated by the Management Centre conducted research on how to achieve economic convergence before and after a solution the findings of the research relating different sectors such as tourism, higher education, labour mobility, adoption of Euro and green line trade were presented in five conferences during 2005-2007.

What has been the impact of all this work and efforts will be discussed further on in this Report. Nevertheless, much work continues today to encourage Greek Cypriots and Turkish Cypriots to engage in a new dialogue about the present day deadlocks and future possibilities on the island. It is amply acknowledged that any solution would need the citizens' cooperation and commitment for it to work. And this is what the citizens' peacebuilding process has been trying to do in Cyprus.

Funding

The funding for these bi-communal activities and workshops was initially provided by the US Agency for International Development (USAID) directly or through the Cyprus Fulbright Commission or, for programs in the United States, AMIDEAST.¹⁸ USAID later channelled most funding through the United Nations. From 1998-2005, the UN-

¹⁷ Varosha was developed as a tourist area, with high-rise hotels, to the South of the old town of Famagusta. The properties were mostly Greek Cypriot-owned, and following the events of 1974 and the division of the island, Varosha was fenced off. It has remained unoccupied since then. Several efforts by the United Nations to promote confidence-building have proposed a reopening of Varosha and return of Greek Cypriot property in the fenced area, but to date none has succeeded.

¹⁸ The America-Mideast Educational and Training Services, Inc. (AMIDEAST) is a private, nonprofit organization that aims to strengthen mutual understanding and cooperation between Americans and the peoples of the Middle East and North Africa. AMIDEAST provides English language and professional skills training, educational advising, and testing services to students and professionals in the Middle East and North Africa. It administers educational exchange programs, including the Cyprus-America Scholarship Program (CASP), which provides scholarships for Greek and Turkish Cypriot college students to study in the United States, and since 2000, the Bi-Communal Support Program established by the US Embassy in Cyprus. See <http://www.amideast.org/default.htm> (accessed April 1, 2008).

based Bi-Communal Development Programme (BDP), created to help foster positive and cooperative relations between Greek Cypriot and Turkish Cypriots by helping them to design and implement projects of common interest, worked with over 300 different Cypriot organizations and supported some 220 projects. The programme was funded by USAID with additional funding from UNDP totalling \$67 million over 7 years. These projects had a strong focus on supporting educational and cultural exchanges, youth projects and empowering NGOs to play a more active role in promoting a dialogue in the Cypriot society. One of the main achievements of this program was to fund the establishment of the Management Centre (www.mc-med.org) in the North and the NGO Support Centre (www.ngosupportcenter.org) in the South, which worked sometimes bi-communally and sometimes in parallel to foster cooperation between the communities as well as building the capacity of the Civil Society in both communities. (See Appendix C for more details).

BDP was succeeded by UNDP-Action for Cooperation and Trust (ACT), launched in October 2005. It is managed directly by UNDP and has a total budget of \$26.5 million for three years (October 2005 – September 2008). The project funds over one hundred projects with the aim of increasing cooperation and trust among all communities in Cyprus. Each project must have a bi-communal component to the project. Although all one hundred projects must strive towards the aim of promoting cooperation and trust, each approaches this objective differently. Some do so by creating advisory groups, strengthening the capacity of civil society organizations, or restoring the rich cultural heritage of the island. Other projects promote cooperation and trust more concretely through youth camps, education initiatives, CR trainings or bi-communal youth programs. The Cyprus Civil Society Strengthening Program (CCSSP), launched by funding from the UNDP-ACT and implemented by a consortium consisting of INTRAC, The Management Centre and the NGO Support Centre, has been the largest civil society capacity building program implemented in Cyprus with an aim of promoting trust and institutionalizing cooperation between the two communities to work together to strengthen the Cypriot civil society and increase the capacity of the NGOs.

The United States Embassy retained its own direct funding mechanism, appointing a Bi-communal Coordinator in the 1990s and institutionalizing its funding mechanism in 2000 with the establishment of the Bi-Communal Support Program (BSP). This program allows Greek and Turkish Cypriots to explore issues of common concern together through theme-based projects in areas such as education and health, youth leadership and crisis management. Activities BSP has funded include youth camps, English language programs, professional development study tours of the non profit sector to help youth better understand civil society's role, and environmental workshops. BSP programs are administered by AMIDEAST, a U.S-based, non-profit organization that maintains staff and an office in Cyprus. In addition to the AMIDEAST programs, BSP also oversees a small-grant fund that supports bi-communal projects that cost under \$10,000. With the help of these grants, Cypriots support their own bi-communal undertakings in Cyprus.¹⁹

¹⁹ <http://nicosia.usembassy.gov/TheEmbassy/Bicom.htm> (accessed April 22, 2008).

Following the referenda, funders shifted focus from dialogue, rapprochement and exploration of federalism and other issues to civil society strengthening, sustainable development, environment and education and youth. This was partly a reaction to the intense criticism levelled at international funders (the UN especially) by the Greek Cypriot Government of biased support and inappropriate advocacy for the Annan Plan in their funding policies.

INTERVIEW RESULTS: EXPERIENCES WITH THE CYPRUS PEACE PROCESS

This section aims to illuminate some of the experiences surrounding participant engagement in the Cyprus peacebuilding process. For the purposes of this analysis, the responses from the interviewees were categorised into five themes: motivation of involvement, obstacles encountered, positive elements, turning points in the process and recommendations from the participants for future processes. These themes illustrate the commonalities and differences experienced by members of each community as they reflected on the peace process in Cyprus. We decided to first analyze the data from each group (Turkish Cypriots, Greek Cypriots and the third parties) separately but using the same thematic categorization and then attempt a comparative analysis highlighting convergence and divergence.

The Turkish Cypriot (TC) Analysis

Motivation of involvement of the interviewees in the peacebuilding process

Participants from the Turkish Cypriot community began their involvement in the peacebuilding process for various reasons. The isolation experienced by the community as a whole from non-recognition of the TRNC contributed greatly to many of the participants' personal reasons for engaging. However, at an individual level there are some interesting findings. Some TCs became involved in the peacebuilding process because they were invited to attend a meeting or a workshop or other types of gathering by an individual they knew personally. Invitations at the behest of the American Embassy, Mediation Association, Fulbright, PRIO (Peace Research Institute of Oslo) and Management Centre also drew many participants into the fold. Still others were invited because of their professional involvements in trade unions, journalist organisations, and academic pursuits.

On the intrapersonal level, motivations for getting involved in the peacebuilding process stemmed from tragedy, personal belief systems and curiosity about 'the other.' Some participants became engaged in the reconciliation efforts because they had lost family and/or property during the violent phases of the conflict. They wanted to somehow reconcile how their experiences shaped their ideas, fears and hopes and how these factors would influence their futures both individually and collectively. Still others felt an inner, deep desire to find out what happened to the Greek Cypriots (GC) with whom they had interacted and whom they remembered from years past when they lived in mixed villages. At the other end of the spectrum, there were many who wanted to participate in the peacebuilding process because they had never been allowed to interact with people from the South and were curious about who they were. Others joined the peacebuilding process because they ascribed to an idealistic and peace-centered personal philosophy of life. This particular group of Turkish Cypriots (TC) followed their hearts and wanted "to live in peace and stop the bloodshed" or simply and perhaps more practically to be involved in a process that aimed to "reach a settlement that would satisfy both sides."

Positive Elements

The excitement of what would be discovered on this adventure into the unknown was bound to produce positive elements on both sides of the Green Line. The analysis of the TC community showed these positives in different areas. One of the most powerful and fundamental for TC participants was that “the feeling of being Cypriots in these workshops [is what] binds people.” This feeling of solidarity helped foster other positive outcomes: establishing good friendships, learning each other’s language, GCs realizing TCs are like them, learning how to be unbiased and break social and political taboos, practicing how to put oneself in the other’s shoes without fighting and developing different and evolving views about peace and the Cyprus conflict.

From these positive elements came fruitful developments. The idea that peace contact was important to pursue despite the politicians’ desire to the contrary led TCs to continue working with their GC counterpart activists to sustain these peace activities and to work to reduce the “feelings of hostility and hatred [which] must disappear.” These ideals were pursued through tangible bi-communal activities TCs undertook and participated in: establishing camps for youth, creating a bi-communal choir, establishing the trainers group that started with the Cyprus Consortium and continued with Ben Broome. They also motivated the desire to rewrite Cyprus history books for schoolchildren..

From the social point of view there were many successful activities at an individual level that led to positive, collective social impacts. These included:

- In 1996, at the urging and with the help of bi-communal groups, a huge public bi-communal activity convened by the UN at the Ledra Palace, with thousands attending, following “violence and an increase in tension along the ceasefire lines unparalleled since 1974.”²⁰
- In 2002, a Common Vision document created and signed by 86 organizations calling on the leaders of the two communities to come to a settlement and outlining criteria for a solution.
- Mass demonstrations calling for signing of the Annan Plan and the resignation of Denktash, staged by a coalition of 91 NGOs, opposition political parties, the Chamber of Commerce and trade unions under the banner, “This Country is Ours,” and attended, according to some sources, by about 60 to 80 thousand people.
- Human chain activity on both sides of the Ledra palace in support of a solution, as well as small demonstrations during the Clerides-Denktash dinners where TC women gathered in the streets chanting, “It is enough, reach an agreement and let’s join the EU together.”

²⁰ Report of the Secretary General on the United Nations Operations in Cyprus, for the period 11 June – 10 December 1996, UN Doc S/1996/1016 (10 December 1996), In August, 1996, a group of 120 motorcyclists arrived in Cyprus with the intention of crossing the cease-fire line. Although President Clerides appealed at the last moment to the group to stop, several hundred Greek Cypriot demonstrators entered the buffer zone and clashed with Turkish Cypriot troops, police and counterdemonstrators. Turkish Cypriot counterdemonstrators were allowed to enter the buffer zone, and beat the Greek Cypriots with batons and iron bars, killing one person. A second Greek Cypriot died in clashes that occurred several days later. *Id.*, para. 4-6. Following the clashes, relations between the two sides became very tense.

With these activities it is estimated that 100.000 people were reached. That was roughly equal to the 65% TC who said yes and the entire “yes” vote on the other side.

These social achievements led to two other realisations. First, money started to flow from outside interests, bringing more international players to Cyprus to support peace-related activities that had impact. The availability of funds from the EU and USA increased and gave rise to international embassies playing a greater role in bringing the two communities together. This was especially true with the US embassy. (It should be noted that trade unions raised their own funds as they felt activities carried out with external aid would have been artificial). The Cyprus Fulbright Commission, with US money, sponsored much of the conflict resolution (CR) work in the 1990s. Other influences, such as businessmen, people from trade unions united, the Brussels group,²¹ the Oslo group,²² the National Democratic Institute and the Harvard Study Group²³ contributed to the development of parameters and functions that were acceptable to both sides.

Second, the people discovered that they were in fact sincere about a solution, but their leaders were not. The change in the leadership of the TC Chamber of Commerce had a big influence over TC society in terms of finance, spirit and ideas in promoting peace and stronger relations with EU. This was the first time that the TC businessmen dared to confront the establishment in the North and joined forces with the rest of the civil society. Two main platforms emerged out of this struggle: the “Common Vision” platform led by the TC Chamber of Commerce which mobilized the civil society organizations outside the public sector and other than the political parties and the unions, and the “This country is ours” platform formed in 2000 and comprised of mainly public sector unions and the political parties. These two platforms managed to put aside their differences in internal economic and political issues and join forces under the banner of “Solution and EU” to stage the mass demonstrations to mobilize a “yes” vote to the Annan Plan.

Another aspect of social cohesion came from the power of the pen or maybe more appropriately, citizen based journalism. Examples include the gatherings of trade unionists and their very significant activity of creating a common terminology amongst the varied groups. This monumental step stimulated cooperation and writing in each other’s newspapers. At least one TC participant claimed that with these activities he “started writing articles in the GC newspaper Politis.”²⁴ Additionally, a bi-communal magazine HADE was published, and from the TC perspective at least, participants tried

²¹ The Brussels group is a bi-communal business association facilitated initially by then US Special Envoy for Cyprus Richard Holbrooke, which developed a number of practical proposals for cooperation (Lende 1996)

²² The Oslo Group brought participants in the mediation trainings run by Marco Turk together in Oslo in 1998. The group produced a statement of shared values and substantive proposals for a settlement.

²³ The Harvard Study Group was facilitated by the World Peace Foundation at Harvard University and the Cyprus Consortium. It brought informed and influential Greek Cypriots and Turkish Cypriots to enrich thinking on the Cyprus issue and facilitate progress towards a negotiated settlement (Chigas, 2008, forthcoming).

²⁴ “Politis” is the third largest Greek language newspaper on Cyprus. It is centre-right, but independently owned.

to reach as many people as possible through press articles, radio and TV programs (but GCs did not do the same).

TCs felt that the positive elements derived during the peace process had an impact on the (TC) yes vote. Those TCs who attended activities made an effort to lobby for the “yes” vote on the Annan Plan in the TC community. TCs believed that the Annan Plan was a direct result of bi-communal discussions, and that this, in turn, led TCs to work hard for the yes vote and “explain the Annan Plan every day to others.”

Obstacles

TC interviewees identified a wide range of obstacles in the peace process, due to the overwhelming feeling that they were fighting “for” instead of “against” something, as they perceived GCs to be doing. The empowerment of people in the peace process events, mass public demonstrations and political change helped to fuel the hopes of many TCs, and when the 2004 referendum votes were counted, all that had been worked for was deemed a loss. The perception of obstacles increased because the stakes were high, and the TCs had invested much emotion and pride.

The obstacles identified focused on personal conflicts, political harassment, military involvement, financial accusations, media propaganda, and TC society and external forces. However, the TC participants focused mostly on blaming “the other” (GC). Although this is nothing new in the Cyprus problem, this time the scars of the past were exposed and damaged so severely as to impregnate the TC community as a whole with a poison that still festers deep under the skin today. After the loss of the referendum, TCs felt betrayed and neglected, that “the GCs do not want us, that is why they said ‘no’.” It left the impression and reinforced the widely held notion that “GCs did not want the TC as equals, as counterparts, as countrymen, as brothers or even as part of the Cyprus landscape.” Peace activists lamented that they had “neglected family time at the expense of work” on projects and meetings,” and some of those involved in peace process lost their jobs or were “harassed” from both sides. Those who had sacrificed so much and were so hopeful now felt as if they had put it all on the line only to be betrayed. The truth for many TCs by 2007 was “that TCs are not a part of GCs’ lives anymore.” This type of rejection “flows deeper than the colours of the Mediterranean that surrounds us all.”

This attitude toward TCs was perceived as coming from the top down as reflected in comments that “the unwillingness of the GC administration to share the Republic of Cyprus,” and that “the GC government tried to prevent bi-communal activities-because they are happy with present situation.” Some TCs believed that the GC government deliberately designed a misinformation campaign so that the GC public “would not be informed about Annan Plan” and that it “failed to make use of the media,” thereby leading the GC people to remain under the influence of the leaders and not think for themselves. The role of the Greek Orthodox Church and its funding of activities to dissuade the “yes” vote came under criticism as well. TCs also held that “through the church and education system, the GC youth are brought up to be hostile towards Turks” thereby making the young generation “status quo oriented.”

On a more personal level, the TCs perceived obstacles in the GC psyche, stating, for example, that “the psychology and mentality of the GCs is not mature or settled,” that “the GCs do not perceive the TCs as equal partners,” that “mentally the GCs have an obsession against the TC identity; their main reason for living is to reduce the TCs to servitude,” and that “federation to Turks is confederation to Greeks.” If one side in a dispute has this type of perception of their counterpart, the possibility for progress becomes almost non-existent because of a basic lack of respect for them. It also leads to an intractable atmosphere tainted with near nationalistic accusations, such as: “the GCs rejected it [the Annan Plan] because of their greed,” and “the GCs have to accept that the TC people have a separate sovereign state and have to stop believing Cyprus is a Greek island.” The heightened climate of distrust has led to the notion that “expansionist nationalism is a dominant force in Greek Cypriot and Greek politics.” TCs began to lash out against GC after the ‘No’ vote with statements like, “if they don’t want us then we will build houses on their lands.” As a result, the two communities came to the point of breaking off and coming apart yet again.

A second powerful force blamed for obstruction of the peace process was the TC political structure. Politicians were accused of “contaminating” the atmosphere and not telling the truth to the people. “We came across many obstacles. Those who were against the regime of 15 of Nov. 1983 were taken to court and attacked by [the right-wing] Volkan newspaper,” said one TC peace activist. Nationalists were considered as a major threat to bi-communal activities, and politicians were seen as too influential vis-à-vis both NGOs and the media, so that there was “no independence of civil society.” The political machine was also blamed for the role it played in keeping the communities apart; meetings with GCs were difficult because “getting permissions before the borders opened was a long procedure that had to be approved.”

The negative message from TC political leaders after the referenda estranged the two communities even more and led to feelings that “when RTP took office the NGOs were told to go back to their duties, and thus the NGOs were silenced or others [who had conspired with the government] were rewarded by being appointed in significant positions; the others who wanted to be critical were abolished completely.” Because of political “corruption,” in 2007 very few people believe in the peace process. Looking inward from the political spectrum, TC participants began to believe that “we failed to institutionalize, and the reason was Denktash, who threatened us and said the moment we institutionalize he would ban it.” More serious allegations that the government was involved in the murder of prominent journalist TC Kutlu Adalı further sullied the respect for the political apparatus.

TC peace activists claimed that two forces were working in partnership with TC politicians: the Turkish military and the TC media. Although the TC media was cited by some TC participants as detrimental to the peace process, their influence was nowhere near that of the GC media. However, there were some similarities, noted by those who claimed “the media treated those who crossed as traitors” and “did not report on bi-communal activities so as to inform others,” and so were negligent in their duties as

professionals and servers of the public good. A parallel can be drawn here with the perceived actions of the Turkish military, who in theory, are in Cyprus to protect and serve the public like the media. They too were accused of “portraying activists as traitors” and conducting “interrogation at the crossings.” This tandem effort made by these parallel forces to dissuade participation can explain why the military and media could be seen as tools for the political machinery.

External forces also raised the ire of the TC participants reflecting on past attempts at peace. Statements deriding the guarantor powers as a “problem” the United States as a country that “uses people like guinea pigs and has a double agenda” show how deeply resentments of external forces run. The old adage “divide and conquer” was revived in the TC comments about the use of political ploys by the US and Britain. Some reported they were convinced that “Anglo-Americans planned everything in Cyprus and tricked the TCs to say yes [to the Annan Plan],” suggesting that the American and British ambassadors went to Talat and requested that he “keep on constructing buildings because this will force Papadopoulos to come to the table.”

As always, Turkey did not escape harsh criticisms about, for example, “Turkey’s policy of delay of the settlement for when she enters EU while the TC people are lost in despair.” Some felt “the biggest threat is Turkey’s military, its intelligence units and people collaborating with them”. One TC remarked that because of the meddling from the motherland “in 15-20 years the GCs will be negotiating peace with Anatolians.”²⁵ Yet TC peace activists also strongly suggested that “the motherland’s suggestion for yes was the determining factor” in the entire peace process and dictated some of the outcomes.

Other external groups drew some scathing responses as well, even though these forces (the UN and EU) enjoyed relative popularity amongst the TC community. A TC peace activist criticised the international community for their lack of support, commenting that “(the) UNDP and the Civil Society program did not give any funds to TCs who were involved in bi-communal groups so as not to upset the regime.” This misstep caused a great strain on the peace activists who needed the monies to help mount and maintain support for the process. More unforgivable and hurtful was the abandonment experienced in relation to the EU’s admission of the Republic of Cyprus (the South) even after GCs voted against the peace process. TCs “felt cheated that we were not going to enter EU together” as a whole country.

Finally, the public at large was denounced for their shortcomings in the process. Most in the TC community were remembered as being “people apathetic and disappointed,” suffering from a “lack of trust and confidence not only among leaders but people too.” TC peace activists decried: “the Cyprus issue is not an individual problem,” and “very few people know what a bi-communal, bi-zonal federation means.” TC participants were threatened by this public ignorance and believed “TCs are in the process of extinction.” The “biggest threat is inertia brought forth by the continuation of current situation,” many noted.

²⁵ “Anatolians” refers to mainland Turks who have come to live and work in Cyprus.

Turning Points

The major turning points for the TC participants in the peace process can be mainly categorised into memories of “before” and “after” the referendum. With the outcome of the voting, one might assume that the biggest turning point from a TC perspective would be, as one interviewee said, “when the GC community voted not to approve the Annan Plan”. However, a close inspection of the interviews tells a different story. The participants almost foreshadow the future with their remembrances of the time before the referendum and how the proverbial handwriting on the wall started to become visible to those most deeply involved in the peace process.

Every historic event that took place from within the TC community in which they overcame seemingly impossible odds and challenged the political and social structure in ways that strengthened the peace activists became tainted with the reality of non-acceptance by their fellow Cypriots. Tantamount significance was also attached to the opening of the crossings; many people thought the “border crossing made easier in 2003 the opportunity to get to know each other and erase the GC’s image of the poor TCs living in poverty and under oppression and occupation.” They hoped “the opening of the borders-would make many prejudices disappear,” but even the concrete benefits attributed to the opening of the borders, such as TCs being able to work in the South, soon became overshadowed with a clearer vision of the practical and negative realities that “there is no political will on either side,” and that “TCs youth saw what the GCs are like, (they were) not ready to embrace and see them as equals.” This was especially true of recollections of the mass demonstrations in support of the Annan Plan. What originally was believed as a way to “instil in the GCs the belief that they can live together with TCs” and was thought to have “convinced the people of Morphou who would have been relocated to vote ‘yes’”²⁶ soon became “demonstrations that the GCs only watched.”

External factors were also seen as all-pervading in the Cyprus problem. Turning points, positive and negative, were linked to “the accession the Republic of Cyprus to EU and the EU membership process for Turkey, which is associated with the Cyprus conflict” The motherland’s presence was cast as a dark blot on the efforts of the TC peace activists’ efforts as it always seemed to overshadow local efforts. The pervasive feeling that “Cyprus is an EU problem, not one of the island’s people” consistently eclipsed the actions of those in the TC community who were giving of themselves so that the movement would prevail. This reality was referenced with dismay in such declarations as “in 1997 when a resolution passed against Turkey in Luxembourg the conflict resolution process was banned.”

²⁶ Morphou is a market town in northwestern Cyprus. Before 1974, its population was almost entirely Greek Cypriot, but it is now under Turkish Cypriot control. The GC population was forced to leave in 1974, and subsequently, TCs displaced in 1974 and earlier, as well as migrants from Turkey proper, settled there. Under the Annan Plan, Morphou would have returned to GC control, and GC properties, now occupied by TCs and Turks, would have been returned to their initial owners.

Obviously, the time immediately following the historic vote in 2004 can now be judged as a dark time for the TC community, as many were disillusioned and felt once again the painful realisation of isolation “when the majority of GCs voted no.” The referendum, however, was not the only election that the participants remembered as monumental. One turning point was noted when “the parties in favour of a settlement came to power in Turkey and the North” and another in the fact that GCs “elected an administration in the South which did not favour a settlement.” The latter however proved to be much more powerful and influential than the former.

The Greek Cypriot Analysis

Motivation of involvement

Peacebuilders from the Greek Cypriot community began their involvement in the peace process for reasons similar to those of the TC community. However, on closer examination, differences begin to emerge. Generally, GC participants joined the peace process due to ideological beliefs. Many were intellectuals or elites who had lived and were educated abroad. As in the TC community, organisations played a significant role. Participants came from the likes of the Cyprus Academic Forum, HAD-women’s group, theoretically involved as scholars or as political leaders from a party promoting rapprochement and solution. GCs also came from business groups, because of the influence of party politics. They became involved for a variety of reasons: the fact that Louise Diamond was coming to the island, because of the Oxford Group publicity or simply as activists looking for an alternative. Others got involved after the opening of the check points in 2003 so that “my children will have the chance to meet TCs and dispel many things they hear about the TCs.” There were also professionals who entered at the invitation of third parties.

Interpersonal reasons compelled many GCs as well. There were participants who were products of a mixed marriage, had family members missing but were from mixed villages and had TC friends or had met and developed friendships with TCs during their student years abroad and thus were more sympathetic to and interested in the TC community as a whole.

Intrapersonal reasons were seen in such statements as “commitment to a solution” but overall were less common than for TC participants. Of course, curiosity played a role since in the 1990s the only way to go to the other side was to join a bi-communal group. Many participants had progressive political views.

Positive Elements

The GC participants in peacebuilding activities had views similar to their TC counterparts of the positive elements that came from their involvement. There was a general consensus that positive things were happening, such as efforts to solve concrete problems. They also appreciated the acquisition of the ability to “get into the other’s shoes.” The Conflict Resolution workshops of the 1990s helped many people come together and gave a holistic view of the conflict. The GCs found the TCs more cultured than expected. This provided an avenue for a real in-depth dialogue on each side’s needs based on values of

mutual acceptance and the ability to see the other as an equal. GC participants reported that workshops were helpful in understanding ‘the other’ and helped them to “realise they [TC and GC] have common goals.” These interactions helped eliminate stereotypes in GC participants’ minds, and the shared activities brought the communities closer and helped establish many personal friendships. The GC participants were able to recognise that the TCs genuinely wanted a solution and saw the Annan Plan as an opportunity to get out of the isolation. Additionally, an interest to learn the conflict resolution process and pass it on to other GCs was mentioned. When this type of breakthrough happened, many GCs questioned their assumptions and beliefs and in turn viewed peace related activities with more tolerance. Some were led to devote all their free time to the peace process.

Despite these positive elements, GCs felt that positive feelings alone could not bring the solution. This pragmatic approach seems to differ from the almost euphoric feelings of TC optimism. Another difference from the TC experience of peacebuilding concerned the activities most valued. While TCs emphasised present- and future-looking activities, the activities valued by GC participants could be categorised as emphasizing the rectifying of the past. Examples include joint symposia to celebrate together the struggles of the 1940s, research on property issues and how well the refugees were informed (PRIO), reconciliation projects such as identifying the bones of missing persons in both communities, joint activities promoting common workers’ struggles and efforts to establish a memorial in Lefka village in the North to honour the struggles of miners from both communities. This is not to say that the bi-communal social activities did not at least dabble in the then present (or hopes for the future) or that many activities were not thought of as well-structured. Many GC people attended concerts, sporting events, etc. Further examples, such as the youth camps for 14-16 years olds, co-villagers meetings, the bi-communal choir, the HADE magazine and the HAD women’s group, speak to the success of the many bi-communal cultural activities that took place

Interestingly, the GCs who participated in the peace process developed positive views on the possibilities that reconciliation could contribute to the future. One GC put it this way: “This [the activities] helped us decrease nationalist dependency and view Cyprus as a common homeland.” Another said, “We [GC participants] imagined a reunited country and would be better off socially and economically in the long run.” The accumulation of experience and knowledge from meeting with “the other” led GCs to be hopeful.

Like their TC counterparts, GCs were not as favourable when it came to views on outside forces. Embassies, foreign governments and funding from these sources were seen in a conspiratorial light as almost corrupting the process and the outcome of future reconciliation measures. Within their own political parameters, however, the GCs were optimistic at events such as the establishment of a bi-communal bureau in the right wing party (DISY), the hope for change in GC community in the forthcoming presidential elections (February 2008),²⁷ meetings of political party leaders and joint activities, and changes in the behaviour of DISY (such as holding Cyprus, rather than Greek, flags).

²⁷ In February, 2008, AKEL leader Dimitris Christofias was sworn in as President of Cyprus, having eliminated incumbent President Tassos Papadopoulos in a surprise upset in the first round of elections, and subsequently defeated DISY candidate and former foreign minister Ioannis Kasoulides in the second round.

Non-politically, there were favourable impressions around the CR workshops in the 1990s. They were perceived as well-designed, and generally GCs thought that the training of trainers was needed, that Benjamin Broome's approach was positive, and that the first bi-communal "vision statement" was a good development. Additionally, youth projects were thought of as good and positive, and the need to learn about each other, and cooperate regarding education systems, environmental problems and how to combat the infestation of drugs, etc. was seen as strong. Civil society dialogue groups also continued in a more systematic way to produce concrete products, i.e. on economy, media, environment and the establishment of a new bi-communal forum that started in Brussels in 2007.

Obstacles

On the whole, participants in the GC community expressed their dismay at internal factors by looking toward the outside for obstacles in the peace process, more so than the TCs. This could be one aspect of the multi-faceted explanation of the overwhelming "no" vote by the GCs. GCs tended to be less self-reflective, as the analysis has shown, especially when it came to the difference in perception of internal factors versus external ones. It is very common among GCs to use the 'conspiracy theory' to suggest the role of outside intervention in the creation of the conflict. One GC interviewee decried the "excuses of external factors to avoid what we should have been doing" as a fatal mistake in the peace process.

Some internal reasons could be attributed to a lack of "social infrastructure." Such capacity deficiencies included what the participants referred to as "the difficulty to make the transfer of change from a small group to wider public," mainly due to a lack of honest communication. Inward reflections were also emphasised regarding the inability of the participants to adequately publicise their campaign and what they had garnered in their bi-communal experience and then relate it to a public. This was attributed to an inability to "market our product." Bi-communal activities were seen as more of an academic and an elite process and not a grassroots one. Many participants thought the late start of the "Yes" campaign, the language barrier-exclusion, difficulty in finding local funding (as opposed to external funds), and the perception that these activities were treacherous and naïve were detrimental to the continuity of positive elements. Another common concern was that politicians and average people felt threatened by bi-communal activities, and that peace builders were vulnerable because they did not have enough political power to engage the government or to bring people from different organizations into the fold. Being short of resources, they could not spread information effectively, and the lack of institutionalization caused a fragmentation of efforts. The lack of specific programs regarding dissemination of information about the Annan Plan, combined with what some participants contributed to as "no vision or theory" for the peace process in Cyprus, made it difficult to overcome the obstacles. Wider audiences who thought the workshops a theoretical exercise that did not touch real political realities just could not be reached.

A part of the existing "infrastructure" that did have the capacity to contribute positively and could have served the public and the civil society peacebuilders' momentum more efficiently was the media. The media engaged in demonizing the Annan Plan, and the

misinformation about the Plan exaggerated fears to the point where there was confusion for the public around what was being said through social networks compared to what was being broadcast via the media outlets. The media also played a vital role in allowing UNDP-ACT bi-communal programs to be demonized in the hands of a small group of rejectionist journalists.²⁸ As a result, the bi-communal process was discredited, and some provisions in the Annan Plan, such as security, property, and voting rights, and were thought of as despicable by many in the GC community.

On a political level, participants expressed feelings of disassociation, with statements such as “we did not have a movement.” This perhaps took on additional weight because of the TC community’s historic marches and demonstrations. The GC participants felt that the nationalist rhetoric was too strong with its “references to the past” and physical imagery of Turkish Cypriot separatism, such as the big Turkish flag on Pendadactylos mountain overlooking Nicosia. The perception that many politicians “built their careers on the Cyprus conflict” did not help to bring more group cohesion either, as those forces worked against whatever “Yes” movement had actually begun to develop and gain strength. Subsequent confrontations between pro-settlement GC political factions on the left and right did not help matters because the politicians then became “the obstacles,” and issues of compromise were not part of any party’s official policies. These factors led bi-communal activists to assert that politicians contributed to a “lack of motivation,” “disillusionment,” “lack of hope,” and the feelings that “the status quo is o.k.” and that “we are fine.” Many people seemed to realise that they could survive by themselves without the other side, as if the division is part of the solution. Papadopoulos was accused of using fear and accusations to scare the GCs and of perpetuating the ideology of separateness and loss in order to prevail. Many GCs thought Talat would be more compromising but were disappointed when this did not materialise.

External factors that eventually became obstacles include both inter-state and intra-state activities. The presence of the Turkish army on Cyprus soil contributed to apprehension and confusion of the peace process. Other external elements included suspicion of US agenda in Cyprus, and, consequently, of the US-funded conflict resolution workshops. Ignorance pertaining to what “the EU is and means as a political alliance” was exploited by extremists on both sides. As far as figure heads were perceived, the UN special envoy for Cyprus Alvaro De Soto was portrayed as arrogant and diabolic, while UNOPS was characterised as “a mess” and as “having behaved like neo-colonialists who looked at us as a job to be done with no consideration for local sensitivities.” UNOPS’ lack of a clear strategy and insufficient transparency exacerbated the fears of the GC community.

GC reflections on the peace process included failures in the GC community as well, especially the political structure. The usual suspects were identified as major obstacles, including:

- The apathy of GC leaders toward the TC demonstrations in 2002-2003,
- The “Denktash conviction” that the two communities cannot live together

²⁸ UNDP came under attack after the referendum for allegedly supporting the ‘yes’ campaign through the activities they funded, and for interfering Cyprus’ internal affairs. An investigation of UNDP finances was launched in the Parliament in the south, and accusations of impropriety lingered for several years.

- Perceptions of TCs as foreigners and not as compatriots,
- GC anger about TC use of and building on GC properties in the North.

Interviewees also felt that the dynamic of the crossings was not utilized by GC politicians, and that the church and nationalist GC refugee associations used their full power and influence to pursue a tremendous negative campaign. AKEL was also seen as a political party that violated all the history and principles of the left movement in Cyprus and sold out to obtain power in the government.

Turning Points

GC interviewees identified milestones or “turning points” in their experience in the peace process in the following ways. The first pertained to the original conflict resolution work or what came to be known as the “training of trainers,” because this step was a “powerful step in the right direction for what would become multiplier groups” and ultimately became what some consider the beginning of the citizen-based peace process itself. Taking into account all the progress that was accomplished within the training group, the next significant turning point happened outside of the functions of the training group but was a direct manifestation of their initiatives. The political forces were influenced to such a degree as to increase their activities by holding “the dinner meetings of Clerides and Denktash,” where the discussions centered on the Annan Plan. This type of informal meeting in a relaxed atmosphere gave the appearance of a gradual move toward friendship and reconciliation because it was not held at a formal, neutral UN-sanctioned or foreign-hosted meeting place. The whole of Cyprus as well as the world saw the first glimmer of hope in these affairs because the news was covered island-wide and internationally. Out of the “dinner diplomacy” came the promise to really pursue the issue of the missing persons by “the opening of mass graves on both sides”. Being stalled for fourteen years with not a single body recovered, the fact that the political leaders were now being active themselves renewed the promise of a solution and gave heart to those in the peace process that one of the most decisive issues in the Cyprus problem could be addressed and finally overcome.

Another hopeful and perhaps bigger turning point came next when a topic that had festered nearly as long as the issues surrounding the missing persons began to be addressed: the separation of the Cypriot peoples themselves. The “opening of the borders” in 2003 was an immeasurable sign of hope that the peace process could yield tangible results for all Cypriots island-wide. For the first time in almost thirty years Cypriots could physically reunite with what had become only concepts in their minds: friends they had lost, properties in which they had lived, villages they had grown up in, etc. The ability to cross was more than just simple journeys to the other side. These journeys “had an impact” and “helped build trust.” The “GC realized how cordial the TC was who kept their valuables.” This realization more than anything else revealed the humanity and bond between the communities, despite the conflict. With this came an understanding and hope for the future. Furthermore, the opening of the crossings also had an effect on the mindset of the GC participants, in that physically going to North allowed them to visually see how life was like for the TC community; especially regarding “the influence of the [Turkish] army on TC lives.” For the first time, GCs could perceive the

separation as it was experienced by the TC community, rather than just how the separation had affected only the GC community.

Contrasting with the TC views of the demonstrations in the North, the effect of the demonstrations was negligible from the point of view of the GC peace activists. Most of the GCs were simply spectators, which at the least, shows the lack of solidarity and real understanding. It seemed as if those demonstrations were confusing to the GC community, possibly because the GC had been subjected to such a long history of misinformation, not only about the nature of TC life and politics, but also about the nature of the TCs' challenges.

The change of political leadership on both sides (as well as in Turkey) was also considered an important turning point by many of the GC interviewees, mostly with regards to how the Annan Plan was going to be presented to the GC community. For GCs, this was a negative turning point, because Clerides' electoral loss to Papadopoulos, coupled with the "GC coalition government, especially with AKEL in power," was an indication that the momentum the peace activists had created was now facing a formidable opponent and increasing opposition to the Annan Plan. Under the Papadopoulos administration, for "first time the GCs realised what a solution would look like" if the Annan Plan was approved. As hindsight teaches, this administration did not provide accurate and unbiased information regarding the Annan Plan, and it soon became apparent that the Papadopoulos administration was determined to squash all support for it. This perhaps more than any other factor proved to be a major turning point in the peace process in the GC community. Finally, many GCs viewed the accession of the Cyprus Republic to the European Union as a new opportunity to use in the direction of influencing the peace process. Others have mentioned the 'Gambari 8 of July' agreement between the two Cypriot leaders.

The External Participants' Analysis

Motivation of involvement

External participants include non-Cypriots who became involved in the peace process either as mediators, trainers, experts, unofficial facilitators, or donors. Some became involved in the peace process as part of their jobs (e.g., US embassy employees, UN employees, the Fulbright commission, Swiss embassy, etc.). Others who came from an academic or non-governmental background and were professional facilitators aimed to empower dialogue processes and/or conflict resolution capacities (e.g., the Cyprus Consortium, Ben Broome, the Oslo Group, the Harvard Study Group, etc.). All external parties can be considered highly educated and dedicated to the success of the peace process on the island.

They had a shared optimism about the will in the people and the possibilities for coming together, as reflected in such comments as "people wanted to do something, but they didn't know what." Those who supported the civil society conflict resolution work believed that the bi-communal workshops "were aimed at putting pressure on a system with no safety valves, by bringing people together at the valve that existed, they aimed at

bending the ruling elites, ” and that “anything bringing people together had to be supported.”

Positive Elements

External participants identified a number of positive elements, particularly with regard to the people involved in the peace process and to the bi-communal meetings and workshops. They saw that “people’s perceptions shifted from they are actively evil to they are people” because of the conflict resolution work, and that myths were debunked. There were powerful memories of the “excitement” of Greek and Turkish Cypriots coming together and the opportunities to initiate “more daring projects.” The most positive aspects for many of the third parties were associated with the work with the youth of both communities. One UN official who resided on the island for several years commented that “the most positive bi-communal efforts were between youth. Young people do not have such deeply ingrained prejudices, and are further away from 1975.” A non-governmental conflict resolution trainer-facilitator similarly commented that “the work with educators and youth was some of the more impactful work.”

Many were encouraged, yet pragmatic about the opening of the crossings. To most, the easing of travel restrictions “did not achieve what had been hoped for” and “it was a mistake to think that this would lead to a solution and to greater cooperation”.

Obstacles

The main challenges these third parties believed the bi-communal movement faced was its reach and its effectiveness within the two communities. There was a group of people who were interested in contacts with the other side and accepted them as useful, but there was a huge majority who thought otherwise and were not interested. There were “people old enough to remember mixed villages,” who had had “positive experiences,” and who knew that the propaganda that the two communities could not live together was “crap”. The bi-communal movement touched something that people wanted, but it could not turn that into concrete support.

The bi-communalists were a “small, hard-core group,” a “cottage industry,” as one UN official put it, noting also that “there was a well-orchestrated campaign against people engaging in bi-communal work.” Other third party actors agreed that the bi-communal movement faced tough odds because they were not representative of the population, and “they, and only they, had links [to the other side].” The groups were seen as working with themselves, but not talking with the people while the rest of the population worked on the stereotypes of the past. “Had the groups been more aware of what was going on when the government was running anti-Annan Plan campaigns, civil society could have been used more effectively.” As one interviewee expressed, “they could have been preparing people for compromise, but they did not take the debate to the people.” This in part may have been because they hadn’t “cohered around a solution; they hadn’t worked it out for themselves.” Several donor and UN representatives believed that “unless society finds a way of energizing civil society to get involved in the debate, it will be difficult to make progress and civil society will be used as it was before.” The question was “how to make this happen in civil society.” The UNDP program now thus aims to strengthen civil

society, to build up an independent civil society that will stand up for each other, whether on bi-communal or social issues.

The bi-communal movement's failure to reach out to the public was not the only obstacle identified by external participants. All noted that neither leadership prepared the people for compromise. Both sides focused on what they could sell politically because the idea of compromise was difficult. For most of the past 30 years, "others were always to blame." The parties felt they had "no obligation to cede anything;" since the other side was to blame, "*they* should make concessions, not us." Additionally, some interviewees noted that "there was no self-interest on the Greek side, and there was no sense of a moral obligation to compromise in the negotiations."

Propaganda was also driving the way people thought and acted. The media and most politicians used their power to "actively dissuade the public" by the use of "misleading" techniques that led many people, for example, to believe "their side committed no atrocities against the other." The language used on each side was considered confrontational and zero-sum to the third parties who observed its exploitation and use: "there is never the language of reconciliation; it is always hard-line." The use of propaganda was not exclusive to the media, but rather permeated the whole society, through the role of education and the youth. As a UN official with experience with the civil society and official peace processes reflected, "The education system was an active contributor to the conflict. When UNDP translated parts of textbooks, we discovered that even textbooks in math, French and reading were laced with references to refugees, etc". Another high-level UN official on the island noted that "more work needs to be done with youth and universities to leverage the power of youth who on the GC side were the rejectionists."

There were substantive obstacles as well, particularly in relation to land and property issues and the fate of settlers from Turkey. Ownership and return of Greek Cypriot properties in the North was complicated by the large amount of housing construction on GC properties in the North. Previous efforts had "not been comprehensive," a UN staff person commented. "The idea", she noted, "was to devise something that would allow GC to retain their attachment to their ancestral lands and alleviate TC fears of threats to their security and identity and we tried too late to bring a simplified answer." She continued her assessment by saying that, "the process was all confidential, and the UN didn't have "hands in the marketing." This was because of the UN commitment to not betray confidentiality.

With respect to the issue of the settlers from Turkey (who are not Cypriot), according to some interviewees, "the North was becoming more and more like a province of Anatolia." "There was an outcry in the TC community when there was the proposal to teach the Koran in schools during the summer holidays," some noted, and "there has been an increased building of mosques." Unfortunately, these last two obstacles are increasing as time passes without a solution.

Finally, a member of the UN mediation team described what he termed as a “linkage failure” as another obstacle to the peace process. He remarked that he “was unaware of the groups doing track two dialogue” and “did not see a great deal of impact of the ideas of the track two processes, perhaps in the confidence-building arena” as they were “not directly relevant to the processes, even if perhaps to long-term attitudinal change.” UN staff working on the Annan process was aware of the informal dialogue efforts (like the Harvard Study Group) going on, and it was “interesting to look at their proceedings.” The problem as one member of the UN team saw it was that they were “talking to people that were not necessarily representative of the people who had to vote on the referendum.” A long-time non-governmental facilitator commented in a similar fashion on the linkages amongst track two efforts; he was “not sure there were conscious attempts by third parties” to link their efforts to each other’s or to Track I, not since the “overall vision that Louise and Diana had for connecting the efforts.”²⁹ A lot of what happened was opportunistic. There was an opportunity to do something specific, partly because of funding (e.g. a different administration came in, they wanted to do something different), but the movement didn’t do much to connect with what had gone before.

Interestingly, a member of the UN mediation team noted, the decision making/peacemaking was “conducted in a tight-knit circle and there was not a great deal of linkage of civil society into that process.” Civil society, he believed, could not be so effective; it was “difficult” because everything was decided by the President on both sides. “The only issue on the island is Cyprus, and the traditions of leadership on Cyprus are personality-centred. So everything in peacemaking was at the top.” Still, another UN official thought, “marketing the solution within the constraints of a highly confidential process would need to be thought of. The UN and pro-settlement groups didn’t communicate in the way that the OXI [‘NO’] campaign did.” This was apparent in the lead-up to the referendum, “when there was an active campaign against the Plan” that was well-orchestrated, “including an association back to W.W.II “OXI” Day, when Greeks in Greece refused (said ‘NO’) to collaborate with the fascists. The message was that you have to say ‘no’ again, and not give in on rights”. Subsequently, the anti-Annan Plan political forces were able to overpower civil society in swaying the referendum vote.

Turning Points

According to the to the third party actors, one of the main turning points was the change in the North with the initiation and effectiveness of the pro-settlement rallies. It reflected the “maturation of the next generation of leadership, many of whom had been through our program” some trainers said. The rallies opened the door for people to express their desire for something different. TCs who took on the cause for bi-communalism and a yes to the Annan Plan were ready to be hated, as evidenced by the fact that “they had eggs thrown at them; they were booed at public meetings.” They were, as one UN official noted, “committed to their cause, knowing it would be a long-term process.” Although pro-settlement TC forces were helped by TC isolation and the prospect of EU accession (“there was greater need for change in the North,” as one person noted), they also had a

²⁹ Louise Diamond and Diana Chigas were directors of the Cyprus Consortium, which provided much of the initial conflict resolution training and training of trainers sponsored by the Cyprus Fulbright Commission in the early-mid 1990s.

heavy obstacle in Denktash and needed to have a show of overwhelming popular support to overcome this. People were scared of Denktash and his apparatus, but they also believed that “people are on our side but making public that they are pro-Denktash.” In other words, in many interviewees’ opinion, bi-communalism had more support than it appeared.

Also mentioned were the social impacts of the trainings as a number of people in the North who went through the program took the learning seriously. They applied it in their organizations and brought it into the public discourse when appropriate. People in the programs, especially key people, went on television following each major training event to broadcast to the public what they had experienced. In that way they built a base of new ideas in the society. The ideas in the North, when the time came, “weren’t new, they weren’t foreign.” People heard about experiences of people they trusted. On the GC side, by contrast, the system was bigger and less concentrated than in the North (where intellectual capital of the society is close together).

Moreover, in the South, religion had “a braking effect.” Because in GC society there is a natural inclination or tendency to listen to the clergy, the inability to communicate effectively with or coordinate any activities with the church hierarchy or even with the church going part of the community may have been a missed opportunity. One trainer-facilitator commented that “the Church was not addressed, and one can’t do it in a bi-communal setting, and it isn’t clear what one should do with the Church.”

In addition, one diplomat expressed the view that GC politicians and citizens do not know much about life in the North. “They do not know about politics, the difficulties they are having, what the leadership is doing, and the role of Talat is surely misunderstood.” Had there been efforts to honestly evaluate and present accurate information about what was happening in the North to the GC community, then a possibility for greater understanding might have occurred. Of course, there are those who profit from the TC, situation according to some, “and they are those connected to Turkey who do not want her to enter the EU, and there are those who are suspicious of all foreigners and consider them threats because they deviate from the daily rhetoric.”

Finally, work with youth and educators can also be considered to be turning points. A long-time non-governmental facilitator on Cyprus thought that the Youth Leaders project (young political leaders) which brought young political leaders from the entire political spectrum – right to left – was a turning point because they “would not otherwise have gone to a conflict resolution workshop.” This project provided an impetus for them to “get together to talk.” Some things came out of this turning point such as when the GC AKEL youth insisted that the “TC should come to Israeli event when they were invited.” The third party actors expressed a consensus that the youth and next generations have a great potential to contribute to the possibility of a solution as witnessed by their mostly positive interactions.

CONVERGENCE AND DIVERGENCE: ANALYZING INTERVIEW RESULTS FOR CUMULATIVE IMPACT

The following section analyzes the interviews and attempts to draw out themes regarding the cumulative effects of peacebuilding initiatives in relation to the overall factors affecting the process leading up to the referenda on the Annan Plan on both sides, a major turning point in the conflict for both sides. Two methods were used: first, a content analysis in which recurring words and phrases from the interview transcripts were analysed, and second, an analysis of the main themes and divergences both within and between Greek Cypriots, Turkish Cypriots and internationals.

The messages and themes from the interviews were extracted from the recurring words and phrases by looking not only at the number of recurrences, but also the number of interviewees stressing these words and phrases.

Analysis of recurring words and phrases from 40 interviews (13 TC, 16 GC, 11 International)

- “Annan Plan” was mentioned 94 times by 13 TC interviewees out of 13, as against 25 times by 12 interviewees out of 17 GCs and 16 times by 4 international interviewees out of 4.
- “Referendum” was used 36 times by 9 TCs, 26 times by 13 GCs not by any internationals.
- “Crossing/Opening of check points” was used 47 times by 13 TCs, 15 times by 7 GCs and 6 times by 4 internationals
- The word “settlement” and “agreement” were used 48 times and 32 times by 6 and 5 TC interviewees respectively but these phrases were not used by GC interviewees at all.
- The word “European Union” is used 29 times by 11 GC interviewees. However the TC interviewees did not refer to EU at all and was used 11 times by WHOM??
- Civil Society engagement was mentioned even once by neither the GC nor the TC interviewees but was mentioned by the international interviewees 10 times by 4 people.
- The main phrase used by all sides 25 times by 5 TC, 31 times by 8 GC, and 9 times by 5 international interviewees is “political leadership”.
- The word “equality” was used by 3 TCs about 12 times and not by any GCs or other international third party interviewees.
- Economics as a reason behind yes and no votes of were also mentioned by both sides 15 times by 4 TC and 6 times by 6 GC
- Media influenced by political leadership is mentioned 9 times by 6 TCs and 9 times by 5 GCs.
- Nationalism as an obstacle is mentioned 11 times by 5 GCs and 5 times by 4 TCs
- Need for Dialogue is repeated 10 times by 3 TCs and 10 times by 3 GCs
- The word Regime was used 9 times by 5 TCs. And the word military referring to the regime in the North was used 6 times by 4 GCs.

It is very obvious from this analysis that Annan Plan-Referendum and Opening of Check-points was a major turning point for the conflict resolution and peace process. Since the referendum and the disappointing result, however, the TCs have been more preoccupied with the issue of isolation (mentioned by 3 TCs 7 times and not even once by others) as well as keeping the “settlement-agreement” notion in their agenda, and the GCs with matters relating to European Union and “occupation by Turkish troops” (mentioned by 4 GCs 4 times and not even once by others). It is also evident that the TCs were sensitive about the concept of “equality,” but there was no evidence of this sensitivity from the GCs or third parties.

GCs were more concerned with foreigner interference and foreign interests (7 GCs stressed this 7 times but not one TC or third party interviewees mentioned it).

Both TCs and GCs are seeing the political leadership as the major factor in the process, and civil society engagement is only seen by the international players to have a role in the reconciliation process. This has in fact been one of the major issues of discussion in recent years by international organizations such as the UN and the EU encouraging the strengthening of civil society on both sides of the Green Line. It is evident that these efforts fall short of supporting civil society to be a major player, especially in the GC community.

Economics is also seen by both sides as a hidden agenda behind the “yes” and “no” votes of the sides. The interviewees are implying that the TCs said “yes” to the UN plan mainly for economic reasons, while the GCs said “no” because they were scared to lose their privileged position of having a good economy and a relatively rich society. Any new initiative should also take this into account.

Media is seen by both sides as being under the influence of political leadership and a major instrument to block or unblock the reconciliation process. Nationalism is also seen as a reality prevailing in both communities and blocking peace. The TCs see the South as having many of prejudices and taboos towards the other. The regime and the presence of military in the North are also seen as an obstacle by both TCs and the GCs.

Overall we notice that all three groups of interviewees saw the value and contribution of peacebuilding process in Cyprus as very significant to the overall peace process despite its limitations. This section reviews those perceptions of each of the interviewee group.

Greek Cypriots: Similarities and Differences in Analysis of Failure of the Annan Plan

Upon analysis of the answers given by the GC interviewees to the questions posed, four themes are consistently referred to as having great significance for the peacebuilding process: leadership during the peacebuilding process, the European Union accession process, the introduction and explanation of the Annan plan, and the meaning of change in the GC political scene after the referendum’s failure.

Leadership

GCs attribute failure to the influence of several actors on the peace process: international powers, internal political authorities, non-government organisations (NGOs), and the Autonomous Greek Orthodox Church of Cyprus ('the church').

International Powers

In the unique case of Cyprus, international powers – Turkey, Greece and other international actors such as the United States, the European Union, and the United Nations – were seen by some of the GC interviewees as powerful forces who guide the direction of the Cyprus problem in terms of their own interests rather than providing coherent, stable leadership and guidance to address the issues and needs of Cypriots. Due to the complexity of the desires of these international government actors and their changing geopolitical agendas, there was a perception and fear that their leadership would have negative consequences or produce an unfair resolution or settlement. The involvement of funds from outside sources was also viewed with suspicion. One interviewee captured the overall feeling toward the international forces involved when he said, "The hegemonic powers in region will always affect Cyprus." Despite mistrust of the overall direction the international leadership had provided, the interviewees recognised their influence and permanence in Cyprus. One interviewee added, "Not one good idea has come from Cypriots – there have been no constructive proposals." It remains a luxury to blame and accuse those who tried to act.

Internal Political Authorities

The internal leadership based on the island has been greatly influenced by these international forces, yet they have been the most dominant players in the Cyprus negotiations with the power to support or prevent a solution. The leadership on the island was perceived by the GC interviewees as mostly ineffective at best, and at worst, obstructive. As one peace activist surmised, "There is an intense need for people to deal with the truth, but very few people actually address these issues and nobody in the leadership does so. This discourse is not coming from the leadership and it should." Another interviewee stated, "If the leadership and media continue with the same messages, nothing will change. As long as the leadership does not change, nothing will change." It is clear that some of the GC interviewees blame many of the difficulties encountered in the peacebuilding process on the internal leadership's priorities and conduct. As one interviewee said, "Recent surveys have highlighted a very disturbing trend in that GCs now see TCs no longer as compatriots, but rather as foreigners to land which is not rightfully theirs. This is cultivated from the people who control political life." They desired their leaders to behave respectably, be honest in their communications with the public and produce positive results; most were disappointed in the leadership that was provided.

The Papadopoulos administration took special blame from pro-settlement interviewees. "Papadopoulos worked on people's fears...he could have been a better negotiator but he stuck to his opinions related to his personal agenda." At the same time, many interviewees noted that GCs did not understand the dynamics in the North. The fact that TC authorities were led for so many years by the Denktash regime persuaded many to

believe that the change in that leadership to Talat could provide some movement, but lack of familiarity and the North's relationship to Turkey led GCs to receive his leadership sceptically. As one interviewee said, "The role of Talat is sorely misunderstood. Even when he had extreme influence in the TC community the GCs severely ridiculed him, thus he lost his influence and could not deliver. Stating that Talat is like Denktash is an incredible insult." Misconceptions, a lack of respect for the other side's leadership, and an unwillingness to learn about Talat led to a failure to appreciate the gravity of the opportunity for rapprochement that Talat's rise to power offered all involved.

Non-governmental Organisations

Looking to leadership in the area of NGOs and civil society organizations, there were many similarities in the responses from the GC interviewees mainly because there was agreement about the general state of their operations. One GC interviewee said, "Civil society is very fragile in southern Cyprus meaning that the NGOs that do exist are usually attached to a political party or the church. NGOs are usually very small, not connected and do not last long". Another interviewee pointed out that "NGOs have a lack of institutionalisation and difficulty of language. Their activities need legitimisation by the political leaders and need to be discussed in the broader society". "[G]aps in NGO efforts" and failures were seen to be "due to lack of resources and inability of mobilisation." While NGO efforts and roles in the peace process were at the forefront of the overall movement towards exploring a solution, they were seen as mostly ineffective when it came to actually producing influence over the process, because their power was loosely defined, scattered and held no real permanence. Cypriot NGOs were especially instrumental in the initial steps of rapprochement in the early stages of the peacebuilding process, but as the movement grew their influence was seized, controlled or negated by political parties and other powerful forces. However, it is important to note that the GC interviewees generally approved of their leadership in the early stages of the process and thought it provided a framework for dialogue and discussion and a psychological boost to people. As one GC interviewee commented, "there was a need for the NGOs, and there will continue to be a need for civil society engagement, research on issues of importance to the peace process and distribution of information by a non-governmental source." NGOs were at once valued for their contributions to the peacebuilding process and leadership on important interpersonal issues. However, their inability to move this momentum forward was recognised as an inability to lead effectively. These burgeoning organisations who were engaged in a complex situation with more powerful forces who had a longer experience in getting their objectives across did not have the capacity to bring about complete .

Autonomous Greek Orthodox Church of Cyprus

To a lesser extent, but mentioned frequently was another non-governmental leadership role that yielded its power and influence in the peacebuilding process. This position was occupied by the Autonomous Greek Orthodox Church of Cyprus itself. It was seen as so unshakable in its doctrine that it was slow to react to rapidly changing social and political conditions. One GC interviewee expressed that, "the role of the church has been catastrophic; they do not have the right attitude towards tolerance and reconciliation." As the largest land owner on the island and the wealthiest institution, the church used its

dominance to sway people away from the peacebuilding process and into a position of isolation and fear. Parishioners were persuaded by the force of guilt and threat of condemnation, even being told by church leaders that a “yes” vote equalled eternal damnation in hell. All of the GC interviewees who mentioned the church held similar negative views of the leadership role the church chose to pursue.

Overall, the GC interviewees were similarly sceptical of the leadership provided to them on all levels; by international leaders with their own agendas, their internal political leadership with their staunch nationalism, the incapacity of NGOs to influence processes and the church’s negative influence toward reconciliation. All of the influences combined to add to the chaos and did not encourage an atmosphere conducive to finding a solution best for all parties. True leadership comes from the wisdom of the people and is promoted by its leaders to best serve the needs of the country and in this one finds pieces of justice for all.

The Influence of the European Union Accession Process

Much emphasis was placed on the influence of the EU’s 1999 Helsinki decision, which paved the way to allow southern Cyprus into the EU without a solution to the Cyprus problem and gave Turkey a process for accession negotiations. Many GC interviewees believed a bona fide solution was not pursued on their part because there was no real obstacle for their prospect of EU membership. One GC interviewee lamented “They should have squeezed the GCs and made it a requirement for accession to the EU to reunite the island.” Another explained, “The accession process was a huge missed opportunity which undermined the solution and going together into the EU, the great chance was joining the EU and joining together – it was the moment for a solution.” Within the GC community the desire to join the EU was driven in part by the belief that EU membership would provide leverage for their side and strengthen their chances of gaining an edge in the negotiations of the Cyprus problem. As one GC stated, “People (GCs) expected that after we get into the EU certain amendments would be made so as to get rid of certain negative elements and then will move forward toward a solution.” This view was shared by the Papadopoulos administration and was a manipulation of the spirit of the EU accession process; instead of working issues out in a good faith manner with fairness for all, the GCs hoped to gain an advantage through their EU membership to push their agenda and not to enter fairly into an agreement with their TC compatriots. As a result, there was no incentive for the GCs to seriously entertain how EU accession could help achieve a solution and there was certainly no leadership from within the GC political structure to pursue this objective.

The GC interviewees held differing views of the TC agenda regarding EU membership. Some thought TCs were motivated to vote for reunification in order to obtain the benefits of EU membership related to recognition and economic growth. One GC stated, “The EU factor was viewed by the TCs in economic terms, and it was imposed by the GCs on them.” Others saw the TCs as genuinely interested in EU membership as a vehicle to achieve a solution to the Cyprus problem. As one GC interviewee stated: “the TCs voted ‘yes’ because of their desire to get into the EU as a reunited island.” Of course, this issue could not be separated from the larger geo-political picture, as exemplified by the

statement from one GC: “The EU was significant especially for the TCs because they saw it as a big possibility and an important force, but also as a negative aspect because the EU can use Cyprus as a scapegoat to keep Turkey out.” Another GC interviewee stated, “The goal was to advance Turkey in its relations with Europe and the US. It was very political.” On a deeper level, this was a justification for GCs rejecting the plan in hopes of obtaining more gain once inside the EU apparatus. One GC interviewee said, “For us, rejecting the Annan Plan was seen as a way to delay a settlement so that we could renegotiate certain aspects of the plan later.” When citizens are voting on issues that will shape their future for generations to come as well as settling long-term issues, they need the reasons to be clear and easily defined, not an undue burden to be dismissed and settled later.

Introduction and Dissemination of the Annan Plan

Hardly any one subject could at once contain similar and different viewpoints as the controversial Annan Plan. There was a general consensus that it was doomed from the start because even though it was worked on by GC and TC politicians, it was also crafted with the assistance of the international community, leading many GCs to believe it compromised Hellenism for the interests of geo-political interests, especially those of Turkey. One GC interviewee declared, “Had the TC themselves produced the Annan Plan, I would have accepted it; my ‘no’ vote was to the drafters of the plan not to the TC community.” Another GC interviewee said, “Some of the details of the Annan Plan were despicable such as the issues of security and property and the vertical line drawn around the sea coast; there was a violation of rights.” Even those GCs who desired a solution and were most intimately involved in the peacebuilding process felt certain issues the plan addressed were a bit unfair.

Additional similarities emerged from many of the GC interviewees who expressed that the public announcement, dissemination of the information and handling of the plan needed to be presented with more honesty and transparency. One GC interviewee reflected the views of many others in stating, “The plan was not explained properly and no criteria were put to approach it, and there was no criterion set for the evolution of the plan into something better.” Another GC interviewee added, “Instead of finding out the positive elements of the plan like the TCs, the GCs were persuaded into a perception of loss and nothing to gain.” For many, “The ‘no’ vote was very sentimental, based on economic considerations and easy slogans, patriotism and in general, afraid of change.” All of these sentiments were similar in their understanding that the GCs had been unable to approach the plan in a spirit of reconciliation or pragmatism because of the manipulation of their emotions by GC political machinery. The real tragedy is that people made their decisions based on the wrong information.

Change in the Greek Cypriot Political Scene

Almost unanimously, the GC interviewees spoke about the effects that a change in the GC political structure in 2008 would mean to the peacebuilding process. No matter the political affiliation of the GC interviewees, almost all recognised that the only way forward to a solution was a change of government. If this change did not occur in the next election cycle, partition would be the future of Cyprus, as suggested in these statements

reflecting the sentiments of most GC interviewees: “Currently there are presidential candidates who provide hope that would come after a Papadopoulos loss; his loss will be good to rekindle hope and optimism,” “If Papadopoulos is chosen again we shall stay divided,” and “This is our last chance; we need the political situation to change to make any impact”.

Turkish Cypriots: Similarities and Differences in Perceptions of Factors for Success in the North vs. Failure in the South

Three main areas emerged from the analysis of the answers given by the TC interviewees to the questions posed: the Annan Plan and the role of the media, the role and influence of internal politics during the peacebuilding process, and what a conflict settlement would look like. In this section these main areas are explored for their similarities and differences of meaning to the TC interviewees.

Annan Plan and the Media

Many of the TC interviewees emphasised the influence of the different media coverage and public discussion each community received about the Plan on the two sides of the island. From their perspective, the Annan Plan was openly discussed among the TC community. Discussions in the broadcast and print media gave a comprehensive picture of the plan for all TCs to adequately judge for themselves the merit of the proposal. As one interviewee said, “It was discussed publicly, on TV, everywhere; everybody knew what it was about.” Television played an especially crucial role in the North as stations hosted debates and discussions with pro- and anti-Annan Plan people and allowed for the discussion to get into detailed exchanges. The media in the North was widely considered a model of effective communication during this time. Many of the TC interviewees credit this transparency and open public debate to the plan’s success in the TC community.

Conversely, many TC interviewees claimed that their Greek Cypriot counterparts did not have the chance to receive sufficient and detailed information about the Annan plan. One interviewee believed that in the GC community, “many rumours had been spread and the people voted in line with these rumours.” “The Greek Cypriots were not informed about the Annan Plan. Giving information about the Annan Plan was banned on television and in the press,” said one TC interviewee. This lack of a common discussion forum was mentioned as a reason for the insufficient and imbalanced information leading to the failure of the plan’s passage in the South.

Media was not entirely to blame. One of the TC interviewees displayed his shock at how the situation unfolded when he said, “It is unbelievable that the two communities haven’t sat down to discuss the Annan Plan.” The fact that no bi-communal public discussion took place was seen as a grave disservice to the people and democracy itself and one of the main reasons the possibility of the plan’s ratification was drastically reduced.

Role and influence of politics

TC interviewees generally agreed about the role of the GC political leadership during the peacebuilding process: that the GC political establishment did not allow for or partake in valuable and transparent discussions about the Annan Plan. The TC interviewees agreed that there was a concerted effort from the highest levels of the GC establishment to ensure the Annan Plan's failure. One interviewee expressed, "Papadopoulos orchestrated the OXI (NO) campaign, and this killed the peace process." The general feeling was that from the very highest levels of the internal GC political structure on the island, there was an active crusade to prevent reconciliation. Some interviewees claimed the GC political leadership deliberately misled their own people with disinformation in order to influence a 'no' vote. Not all the criticism was levelled at the government. Some of the blame was specifically prescribed to traditionally sympathetic sections of the GC political machinery, such as the communist party AKEL. As one interviewee said, "Had AKEL promoted a yes-vote, the GC result would have been more positive and the impression on the international community would be more positive." This caused a lot of pain and strife within the TC community, as now it felt completely isolated even by the community's own compatriots.

Still, there were differences in opinion among the TC interviewees regarding the reasons GCs voted "no" to the Annan Plan. Some TCs believed that the political incentives for TC and GC to ratify the plan were just too far apart. One interviewee said "For the TC any political solution would be better than the existing situation," but, as another stated, "since the GC would be part of the EU political system anyway, regardless of their vote on the Annan Plan, they had little incentive to approve plan to help the TC join the same structure." Still other TCs pointed out that there were different political realities on the TC and GC sides. He said, "The TC thought their problems would be solved if they voted in favour of plan and the GC did not face these problems, so this provided very little enticement to agree on the Annan Plan." This incentive based political reasoning was separate from the GC leadership's role in their non-support of the plan, but played a major role in the failure of the plan's confirmation. There were also some allusions to other reasoning's about the plan's failure such as not enough political protections allotted to the TCs and that there was not an effective enough leadership on the TC side that could appeal to the GCs politically as a leader and someone they could trust.

Settlement/ Agreement

When asked what a settlement would look like, the TC interviewees expressed many things in common. The overall idea was that the TCs could not be the only ones asked to give in because the peace agreement cannot be made with efforts of only one side. As one interviewee said, "Both communities should have a clear and equal desire for a lasting peace agreement." It was the lack of clarity from both sides that would eventually doom any agreement.

The TC interviewees also had some reservations about the international powers and their role in the settlement and peacebuilding process. They felt that as a whole the United States, the EU and Turkey all secretly supported non-settlement probably do to with geo-political goals unbeknownst the TCs themselves. This was a bit surprising because the

TCs trusted these powers and showed their faith by actively supporting a settlement. There was confusion about the role of the US activities in particular, since the US was promoting bi-communal activities but also supporting the GC state, and by that action was actually hindering any possibility of a settlement process. As far as Turkey was concerned, the TC interviewees believed that Turkey had postponed the idea of a settlement until after its accession to EU, perhaps aiming to achieve a settlement in Cyprus and EU membership simultaneously. Most TCs thought an agreement would have been possible had these two been put together. Additionally, the future prospects of any settlement became more difficult once the South was part of EU. To the TCs, this was another example of there not being true and valued equality between the two sides by the international powers.

The differences in viewpoints from the TC interviewees about a settlement have to do with the fact there is actually an absence of violence, or a peace deal, but the tangible agreements about co-existing are missing. In order to achieve a settlement, political issues needed to be undertaken directly and worked out in a way that retained the idea of peace in the background by focusing on the concrete measures a settlement agreement would ensure. Furthermore, TC interviewees felt that sharing geography and culture was not enough for a settlement; they needed validation and protection of their political rights under a recognised system. One TC interviewee said, “A settlement is when the two communities have established good neighbourly relations, without nationalism and fanaticism.” It is the combination of all these ideas and viewpoints that would have yielded a true settlement through the peacebuilding process for the TC interviewees.

International Interviewees: Similarities and Differences in Analyses of Impacts of Peacebuilding

Analysis of the answers given by the International interviewees revealed three main areas: the Annan plan, civil society engagement and the achievements of the bi-communal activities during the peacebuilding process. In this section these main areas are explored for their similarities and differences of meaning to the international interviewees.

The Annan Plan: Outreach and Mobilization

The international interviewees held similar views about the Annan plan in the sense that they saw its failure as a by-product of the way Cypriot politics are constructed, the restrictions and constraints of a highly confidential process that had to be followed by the international players, and the differences of organisation within the two communities. With regards to the Cypriot political situation, the responses identified the structure of the political organisations as important. One interviewee said, “It is the way Cyprus does politics; along party lines, different groups, no planning, not organising around the Plan, at least not early enough.” Another spoke about the power base in Cypriot politics when she said, “We just couldn’t match the organisation and resources of the ‘no’ campaign.” Politics in Cyprus, as in most places, is a dynamic process, but the strength of the politics of the past seems especially powerful in this situation. In this case it was difficult for the

participants in the peacebuilding process to challenge the status-quo and form strong enough alliances to prevail or persuade people of their convictions.

There was a general understanding among the interviewees that the international community, for all their perceived power and influence, were actually not able to actively and effectively campaign or utilise all their resources once the Annan Plan was released for public comment and scrutiny, for fear that any effort to intervene in the process would be seen as interference in the internal affairs of a political process. As a UN official noted, “Reaching out to the communities and the media was a job for the [political] leadership, not the UN.”

Some of the international interviewees attributed the failure of the Annan Plan to the inability of the peacebuilding and bi-communal forces to effectively message to their communities, in the South in particular, as contrasted with the North, where they perceived greater organisation, commitment, and ultimately, effectiveness. As one interviewee said about the attitudes of the TC side, “They felt like this was it. They were never going to have this opportunity again.” “They walked the walk. Campaigners went to the villages, the town halls, etc. They did this for a long time, a couple of years, and they were not daunted by setbacks.” Conversely, in the GC community, “[t]here were a lot of concerned people who talked about what they should do, but not so much action”. Another international interviewee remarked, “The GCs were not in touch enough with what was going on in the North. They had few contacts relative to what they had before and didn’t get out and work with people.” The differences in the styles of how the two communities chose to address their fellow citizens were reflected in the outcome of the judgements passed on the Annan Plan. According to the international interviewees, in the North the campaign was able to capture the people and bring about a tangible change, whereas in the South the GCs in the peacebuilding process failed to communicate effectively enough to change hearts and minds, in part because they were not representative of the opinions of the overall population.

A difference in opinion amongst the international interviewees came in the perception of the aforementioned outreach efforts. Not all the international interviewees gave credence to the argument about organisation and persuasion abilities. The length of the decades’ long dispute had in their opinion so adversely affected the people emotionally and mentally and that each side was so entrenched that it could not make concessions. As one person commented, “It was not all the fault of organisation, most of it had to do with what each side could sell politically.”

Civil Society Engagement

The role that civil society engagement played in the peacebuilding process from the viewpoint of the international interviewees was very useful and to an extent successful in ways not measured by the achievement of a comprehensive solution to the Cyprus problem. To most of the international interviewees, the people involved in bi-communal activities were pioneers who deliberately put themselves at risk to exercise their right of political defiance.

The predominant theme from the perspective of the international interviewees regarding the achievements of the bi-communal activities during the peacebuilding process in Cyprus was the idea of people coming together and doing something to subvert the dominant political paradigm, to have their voices heard and to bridge the differences in the cross community dynamic. Regardless of the fact that at the beginning the people who chose to become involved in this process did not know what exactly they wanted to do or how to achieve it, the desire was there. That was an impressive ideal to which the international interviewees were attracted and a place where they could be instrumental in providing aid and guidance.

The courage and persistence of the civil society actors to continue their work within the peacebuilding process, even when faced with daunting odds, impressed many from the international community involved in the process. One interviewee said, “You have to give credit to these individuals, they just keep at it.” Another said, “The engagement from civil society was a movement that touched what people wanted.” This type of inspiration led to a “horizontal spread” in society. “The ideas spread into different layers of society, mostly the intelligentsia, management and universities; also some local governments like the municipality in Pyla.” The overall impression was that the engagement of civil society in the peacebuilding process was an inspiration to the international interviewees even for all its shortcomings because it was led by people who had been involved for years in preparing for an eventual breakthrough to the stalemate. These actions have led to the present day financial support from the international organisations for activities to strengthen civil society, whether on bi-communal or social issues.

The achievements of the bi-communal activities

The bi-communal activities encouraged the idea that major achievements could be produced. One interviewee said. “A number of people took the learning seriously. They applied it in their organisations and brought it into the public discourse when appropriate. In that way they built new ideas into society.” This reflected the maturation of the peacebuilding process. From this perspective it seems that the momentum was generated to include all Cypriots and make inroads to an all inclusive monumental breakthrough that would reach all Cypriots.

Yet from this space of nothing came the opportunities to actually produce and do something meaningful and to attract others to the developing movement. The difference in the interviewees’ perceptions was in the effectiveness of this group to communicate on a broader level. One international observer commented: “They didn’t convene people; we noticed it, commented on it, but they did nothing about it.” Another said, “they were not thinking as a movement; they were thinking as little groups or individual groups. They did not explore all avenues for influence.” It is evident from these comments that the internationals recognised and were hopeful about the potential of the bi-communal peacebuilding activities, but saw limitations in their failure to link to the macro level especially in the GC community, and to develop a strong bi-communal political movement.

The main criticism of the civil society efforts was that the people involved in the peacebuilding process did not focus their efforts clearly enough. Weaknesses identified by international interviewees included:

- Lack of representativity: bi-communal activists “were talking to people that were not necessarily representative of the people who had to vote on the referendum.”
- Lack of linkages: “Linkages were weak,” on interviewee commented. “People came in and tried to make it work in a collaborative way, but often it was not reciprocated.”
- Lack of vision and common understanding of the situation: One interviewee said, “It wasn’t clear; they had no common vision or common understanding of the situation they faced.” This may have come from the fact that the separation meant that the participants did not know each other well. “They had confusing notions about what peacebuilding actually meant; they had different conceptions of peace itself.” Additionally, none of the people involved had an idea about what difficulties the people in the other community faced. As one interviewee stated, “They did not have a good sense of what it took to engage in peacebuilding on the other side.”
- Missed opportunities, including the failure to respond to the trauma of the crossings opening that affected both communities. Civil society should have been positioned to help this, but failed to deal with it effectively.

Some of the international interviewees wondered if all the effort put forth was too much of a cost for not enough of a return. One interviewee said, “It cracked. It depleted people’s life force, energy and there was no money; there were also no tangible results”.

CONCLUDING REMARKS AND REFLECTIONS

The efforts to find a mutually acceptable solution to the Cyprus problem historically have been confined to negotiations between the leadership of two communities with Turkey, Greece and Great Britain (the three guarantor powers), and increasingly the US in the background. It is therefore not surprising that the interviewees did not emphasise the role of civil society in the process until the civil society-initiated mass movement in the TC community to support the Annan Plan.

Yet, from the previous analysis it is clear that a great deal of peacebuilding work (training conflict resolution workshops, interactive problem-solving workshops, communication workshops, bi-communal projects, meetings, contacts, visits, etc.) did take place in Cyprus over the last two decades. The question is what impact these peacebuilding activities had on the bigger peace process and what linkages existed between macro and micro levels. It is clear that these peacebuilding activities impacted each Cypriot community differently and led to different outcomes. Why? The process of mass mobilization in the TC community in the early 2000s deserves a closer look, in contrast to the GC experience.

A first observation concerns the linkages between civil society and official peacebuilding and peacemaking efforts. When one looks at the history of bi-communal activities, it is not surprising that their intensity were correlated with the official peace negotiations at the so called “track one” level. The very first systematic conflict resolution group started in 1985 at the initiative of Professor Leonard Doob in 1985, during the time when the then Secretary General of the UN Perez De Cuellar put the first comprehensive peace plan together and was very close to get the consent of the two sides. The second series of workshops of ‘bi-communal’ peace activists meeting by the facilitation efforts of Louise Diamond and Diana Chigas came at a time in the early – mid 1990s. At that time there was a serious official attempt to get the two sides’ leaderships agree on “set of ideas” and “Confidence Building measures” presented by UN Secretary General Boutros Boutros Ghali and once again the two sides came very close to an agreement. The intensity of these activities continued with mushrooming groups facilitated by various foreign academic experts such as Benjamin Broome and Marco Turk sponsored by the US-funded Cyprus Fulbright Commission and by other international organizations, such as PRIO of Norway.

The critical mass of the TC peace movement came at a time when the UN was developing the most comprehensive peace plan in Cyprus’ history, with support and leverage from the US government, the UK government and the EU. This was a time of positive developments in the external environment: Greek-Turkish rapprochement initiated by George Papandreou and Ismail Cem in the 1990s; a change of government in Turkey and intensified efforts of the new Turkish Government under the leadership of Recep Tayyip Erdogan to pave the way for the start of EU accession negotiations with Turkey; and the rapidly approaching date for EU accession for Cyprus. The only remaining handicap remaining was the Turkish Cypriot leader Rauf Denktash, supported by the military establishment in Turkey, but not so much by the Turkish government. The fear of losing the chance to become part of the EU, and the opportunity of having a Turkish administration open to negotiation despite resistance from Denktash and his allies in Turkey, were big incentives for the Turkish Cypriots to become radical against their leadership.

The ideas and efforts of the bi-communalists in the north were only able to further flourish with these developments at the track one level. The people who were active in the bi-communal groups in their individual capacity were now active in their civil society organizations to mobilize the masses. It was not until the small public benefit CSOs were joined by public sector unions, which had large and strong constituencies such as the doctors, teachers and the civil servants, and the economically independent and strong Chamber of Commerce, led by some of these bi-communal peace activists, started to play a leading role that the movement caught a real momentum. Several mass demonstrations were organized by platforms formed by these CSOs joining forces with pro-solution opposition political parties.

In the GC community, the situation was almost the opposite. Resting comfortable with the intransigence of the TC leadership, neither the civil society across nor the opposition pro-solution political parties organized to develop a critical mass of the peace movement

until the referendum, when it was too late for the marginalized bi-communalist peace activists to generate popular support, except by one of the major political parties. This party (DISY) had been influenced by one of the leading peace activists (who also happened to be the daughter of the outgoing president at the time), and had they stayed in power, perhaps a solution might have been agreed. However, by the time the TC leadership in the North was toppled and replaced with a more pro-solution leader supported by a more proactive, pro-solution Turkish mainland government, the leadership in both GC side and the Greek government had been replaced by a more intransigent GC government in Cyprus and a more indifferent Greek government in Greece.

In both communities, the majority of participants in the conflict resolution workshops, the interactive problem-solving and mediation trainings came from the more educated groups who could speak English. Therefore, although many inspiring ideas were developed by the peace activist groups to prepare the environment for a solution to the problem, and some individuals were trained to use some powerful methodologies and skills to contribute to the peace process, the activities were criticized as engaging mostly elites and being academically-oriented. The fact that the movement was sponsored by international organizations and seen to be guided by foreign interests,³⁰ and that high language skills and sophistication were needed to attend these “workshops” kept these activities at the level of intellectual idealists who could benefit from these trainings and who were bold enough to face the accusations of being “traitors” and “foreign agents” and become marginalized in their own communities. This limited their impact in the 1990s.

In the TC community, this limiting factor was overcome by the mass mobilization campaign for the Annan Plan, which reached far beyond the peacebuilding participants. In the GC community, however, the focus of these activities on producing a mental shift rather than having a political goal (such as for instance to lead to a bi-communal political and social movement) restricted the public visibility of these activities. GCs hesitated to speak out in political terms. Citizens’ level activities were also not linked to Track I, another shortcoming of the peacebuilding activities, which did not build into the trainings and workshops reflection on how to go about achieving it.

The institutionalization of all these peacebuilding efforts into a movement with a shared vision and goals for reunification would have filled in the political gap of an alternative voice as well a Cypriot presence locally and abroad. Yet the power and control the GC political parties exert over civil society actions made this difficult. Of course, the civil society groups did mobilize during the referendum, despite having very few financial resources, but they were overshadowed by the political parties. In the end these groups (such as the “Solution Now Platform”) did eventually join the political parties (EDI and DISY) that promoted a “yes” to the Annan Plan. But the international community, especially the UN, was not active in promoting the UN Plan despite the fact that most

³⁰ Most of these peacebuilding efforts by peace activists or “bi-communal” groups were facilitated by foreigners and sponsored by international organizations and foreign missions, with the exception of some trade union meetings held without structured facilitation by foreigners.

polls in the GC community indicated a “no” vote. What they did was too late, and the people who attended these gatherings to explain the Plan were the converted ones. A joint bi-communal movement supporting the Plan could have given very different messages to Turkey, Greece and the international community. Instead, each side acted unilaterally once again.

After the referenda the political climate changed in both communities. The GC “Yes” supporters were viewed as unpatriotic. The president of the Republic coined them “nenekides,” a very pejorative term, thus weakening democracy and judging the right of citizens to disagree with their leadership’s decision. There followed a period of disillusionment and loss of hope, despite the fact that the Republic became a member of the European Union and leadership’s promises that EU involvement would lead to a better solution to meet GC needs. The TCs were also gravely disappointed with the GC referenda results. What these events show is that in Cyprus the dichotomy of “us” and “them” still prevails and a zero-sum approach is adopted which leads to the deepening of partition and mistrust.

Nevertheless, as our interviewees pointed out the benefits from such encounters and trainings were significant in meeting the ‘other’, the perceived enemy. There is a need for inter-personal and inter-group contacts in view of the fact that the two communities have lived separately for decades and new generations being brought up without ever knowing or meeting the ‘Other.’ That is why the Youth programs and peace camps are still very much needed accompanied by research and evaluation of such programs. The utilization of the opening of the check-points along the Green line could have also been utilized politically with new initiatives and institutional support systems. Neither Track I nor the peacebuilding groups took this opportunity seriously. Research has shown that a substantial percentage of Cypriots from both communities have not crossed because of a variety of reasons (passport or ID showing, fear, not politically correct as long as the North is occupied by the Turkish army, or nationalism). These are additional indications that there is still a lot of work to be done at the societal level.

The conclusion to be reached with all this complex process is that peacebuilding is a multi track and dialectic phenomenon to be pushed and played at different levels of the society in Cyprus as well as a favourable international conjuncture. More important is the availability of the incentives for the sides to get mobilized whether these incentives have to do with security, democracy or economic betterment. In Cyprus GC was eager to join the EU for mainly security reasons and worked for a solution until the time when they managed to achieve this without a solution. In the TC side the economic benefit and democratization offered by EU prospects managed to change the leadership and political position toward the Cyprus problem.

When the incentives are there and the conjuncture is in place, there remains the difficult issue of organizing and pressing activities at cross-community bi-communal level rather than just relying and focusing on mono-communal movements. When the process becomes confined within single community, there is always the danger of falling in the trap of “zero-sum” reflecting in words such as “This plan is good for us and not for the others.” It should rather generate arguments such as “this plan is good for all and in the

end it is a ‘win-win’ so we should push the process together to reach a mutually accepted arrangement internalized and actively supported by a good majority of both communities.”

PROSPECTS FOR THE FUTURE

With the defeat of the rejectionist GC leader Papadopoulos in the elections held on February 24, 2008, there is already a declared new initiative coming from the UN to finally resume the stalled negotiations with an aim to reach a solution to the Cyprus problem. The new president of the Republic of Cyprus and leader of the GC community, Mr. Dimitris Christofias, has reiterated his commitment to a speedy and viable solution and invited the TC leader, Mr. Mehmet Ali Talat, to join in this effort. A renewed sense of hope may emerge. Given our analysis above we need to look at what incentives there are for the two communities to support this new initiative.

On the GC side the two opposition leaders Kasoulides and Christofias both used the inability of Papadopoulos to find a way forward to solve the problem as a theme in their campaigns. They warned the people about the eventual ‘partition’ of the country into two separate entities – a word that traditionally triggers anxiety and fear amongst the Greek Cypriots. The GC community had expected that there would be a “European solution” to the problem following Cyprus’ accession to the EU, meaning that Turkey would be pressured by the EU to concede to a unitary state dominated by the Greek Cypriots for its own EU aspirations. This did not prove to be the case; Turkey was ready to adopt a slower pace towards the EU and not give in to pressures from the GC side exerted through the European institutions, including the European Court of Human Rights.

At the same time, the EU found ways of keeping links with the TC community and their administration in order to ease the isolation of the TC, help their economy to become more even with that of GC, and prepare them for an eventual adoption of the *Acquis Communautaire*.³¹ The European commission also declared on several occasions that the problem was to be solved within the UN framework and accepted principles which were emphasizing a bi-communal, bi-zonal federation with political equality of both communities.

These developments could prove to be generating new incentives for the GCs to look more favourably to a mutually accepted solution facilitated by the UN and supported by the EU. The TC leadership and the Turkish mainland government will find it rather difficult to block a new initiative in order not to lose their upper hand of being the pro-solution side to the conflict. However, there is also a need for pressure and encouragement from the civil society of both sides. Cross community activities will need to have more impact so as not to create the zero-sum campaigns once again and rather design joint activities to emphasize a win-win formula to solve the long lasting problem.

³¹ The *Acquis Communautaire* was suspended in the northern part soon after the accession of the South to the EU.

It was evident from the interview content analysis that any new initiative should focus on the following sensitive areas:

- 1) The empowerment of civil society to influence policy and to establish the necessary mechanisms and institutions to enable the civil society to be more effective vis-à-vis the policy makers should be supported.
- 2) The common economic benefits of a solution for both communities should be more clearly and loudly emphasized.
- 3) More direct and outspoken peace activities concentrating on dialogue about the sensitivities such as 'equality' and 'occupation' should be encouraged and supported.
- 4) De-politicization of education should be promoted and the transformation of this institution into a conflict resolution and reconciliation mechanism where critical thinking and mutual understanding.
- 5) Addressing the role of the media, with emphasis on creating a safe space for a more objective and less politically distorted and one-sided media.

There is a need to build the joint mentality that the Cyprus conflict is a shared problem to be solved cooperatively and that there exists an inter-dependent relationship between the two communities. Strengthening of the peacebuilding civil society is seen to be needed by programs for both conflict resolution training, dialogue groups on different issues, and capacity building for institutions promoting joint projects as well as empowering NGOs. This will produce a new political bi-communal culture and movement as well as policy papers to be circulated both at the societal level and at the Track I. There is a need to develop a third space in which all the peacebuilding groups and independent thinking individuals will have the opportunity to meet and work together. The efforts should be to make the peace process more civil society driven and less political leadership dominated.

It is at this very junction that the bi-communal peace activists can play a leading role with their experience and skills and the necessary networks they have built over the years across the divide. This can only be possible with a firm strategic support and encouragement from the international community and their relevant organizations who believe that peace and stability in Cyprus will make a lot of difference not only for the region but for the security and well being of the whole humanity.

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APPENDIX: TIMELINE OF PEACEBUILDING PROGRAMS/INITIATIVES

Following is a timeline of peacebuilding programs and initiatives from the 1980s through 2007. While the timeline does not include all activities that have been undertaken in Cyprus, it does include a substantial proportion of the activities, and thus can be considered representative. The timeline will give a sense of the evolution of the programming and initiatives over the past two and a half decades.

Timeline of Peacebuilding Programs/Initiatives

1980s:

Early to mid 80s	Professor L. Doob (Yale) held trainings titled “psychological sensitivity training
1985	The “Intellectual Group,” consisting of 7 Greek Cypriots and 7 Turkish Cypriots met for three months at Ledra Palace under the observation of the UN Special Representative for Cyprus, Holger, and facilitated by Prof. Doob of Yale University, U.S.A..
1980s	Unofficial bi communal trade unions, political, professional groups formed to build mutual understanding of concerns and perspectives and to create possibilities for cooperation in view of future solution.
1984	Professor Kelman hosted interactive problem solving bi communal workshops with Cypriot intellectuals living then in the U.S.A., sponsored by the Middle Eastern Affairs Institute of Washington D.C.
1988 - 1993	Ron Fisher at the Canadian Institute for International Peace and Security hosted conflict analysis workshops which had an extensive focus on the education system. The findings and recommendations were published in Reports and academic articles.
1989	British Friends of Cyprus Committee, a bi communal group of educationalists, discussed the role of education in a future federal, bi communal Cyprus at Ledra Palace. A report and a press release were then sent to politicians emphasizing the need to include role of education in peace talks.
1989	The Educational Institute for Democracy and Preservation of the Environment in Germany invited 20 Cypriots to a four- day conference in Berlin to engage in open dialogue on the current political situation and how it affected inter communal relations and

reflect on their role as citizens. Follow up with meetings were held at Ledra Palace Hotel.

1990s:

- | | |
|-----------|---|
| 1990 | The first bi communal social movement formed: The Citizens Joint Movement for a Federal and Democratic Cyprus as follow up to the 1989 Educational Institute. It jointly organized activities until 1991 when Turkish authorities stopped permission with the pretext of TC elections. |
| 1991 | Louise Diamond comes to Cyprus to explore possibilities for conflict resolution work. |
| 1991 | Bi-communal Steering committee of 4 GCs and 4 TCs formed to help in the conflict resolution process work in Cyprus. |
| 1991 | The Peace Centre Cyprus registered officially as NGO. The Centre offers a Conflict Resolution perspective to students of conflict through both mono and bi communal activities. |
| 1992 | Louise Diamond held conflict resolution workshops, one in each community. |
| 1993 | Seminar on the Contribution of an Unofficial Effort to the Israeli-Palestinian negotiations. |
| 1993 | Oxford conflict resolution workshop for 10 GC and 10 TC, including children of Denktash and Clerides, facilitated by Louise Diamond and Ron Fisher. |
| 1993 | First Conflict Resolution workshop for CASP students held in Boston. |
| 1994 | USAID began to fund workshops run by Cyprus Consortium which consisted of trainings in conflict resolution and negotiation skills. These workshops continued until 1997. |
| 1993-2001 | More than 60 interethnic groups formed and received formal training in CR skills, communication, mediation, negotiation, interactive management methodology, intercultural education and dialogue. These groups consisted of special interest groups including: women's group, students, young environmentalists, businessmen, educators, academics, citizens' group, choir, artists, management group, federation study group, EU study group. A |

	coordination group was established and 2 NGO resource centers were set up in each community by UNOPS.
Mid 90s	Bi communal groups met with experts to discuss different types of federalism as a system of governance for Cyprus. Exchange programs also took GCs and TCs to the US and elsewhere to learn about federalism in these places.
Mid 90s	<i>GC and TC Citizens Movement for Democracy and Federation in Cyprus</i> established to mobilize ordinary citizens and the dialogue between GC and TCs and hosted many public discussions to share ideas, goals and positions of political parties in both communities. TCs attended but no GCs, as they were blocked by Denktash. Also hosted foreign diplomats stationed in Cyprus whose countries have a federal system to discuss federalism, organised meetings to jointly study and analyze federation and sponsored cultural events and intra communal activities and discussions.
1993 - 1996	International Conflict Resolution Program of Columbia University and PRIO facilitated meetings between the Cyprus Business Forum with Richard Holbrook, the US presidential envoy.
1994 – 1995	Cyprus Consortium Conflict Resolution Trainings continued including: Project Leaders 1 (Cyprus), Project Leaders 2 (Cyprus), Conflict Resolution CASP Students (Boston), VIPS-Coolfont USA, Training of Trainers (Cyprus), CASP Alumni 1,2,3 (Cyprus).
1994	Seminar on Intellectual Property Rights.
1994	Ben Broome workshops on Problem Definition with Business Leaders.
1994	Harvard Tax Program
1994	Harvard University Conference on Cyprus (USA)
1994	Computer Education Program (Connecticut)
1994	Political youth leaders parties group met.
1994	Interactive Management process facilitated by Ben Broome for 15 GC and 15 TC to develop a strategy for peacebuilding for the next 9 months, meeting weekly and occasionally on weekends to develop a vision statement and plan of activities, including a bazaar at 300 people signed up to be involved in 12 projects.

1994 to 1997	Mid-Level Managers workshop conducted by the International Management Development Institute, University of Pittsburgh, Cyprus sponsored by the Cyprus Fulbright Commission. These seminars resulted in a joint effort to set up a bi communal Management Centre, which later evolved into two centres, The Management Centre in the north and the NGO Support Centre in the south.
1995	Ben Broome conducted a Problem Definition workshop for youth leaders.
1995	Ben Broome conducted problem solving workshops with young business leaders, youth leaders and women's groups.
1995	Conflict resolution workshop for educators. The second workshop in 1996 resulted in the formation of a group to explore education systems in Cyprus.
1995	Aikido, Chris Thorsen, hired by Cyprus Consortium
1995	EU Federation study group formed which continued through 1996.
1995	"Train the Trainers" and "Training of Facilitators" workshops hosted by Ben Broome produced local team of Cypriot trainers on Interactive Management methodology.
1995	Peace concert held.
1995	Young Business Leaders Group was invited to Brussels to present the views of both communities on Cyprus' accession to EU.
1995 - 1997	Cyprus Consortium Conflict Resolution Trainings continued including: Advanced training of trainers (Cyprus), Conflict Resolution CASP Students (yearly in Boston), VIPs (Airlie, USA), Educators (Boston), Youth Camp (USA), Project Management (Cyprus), Mediation (Cyprus).
1995-96	Bi Communal Women's Group formed to try to understand what has contributed to the pain and suffering in Cyprus. Insights to obstacles included psychological, structural, historical and political, and philosophical.
1995	The International Management Development Institute at the University of Pittsburgh held a workshop for Senior Level Executives in Pittsburgh.

1996	Mid-Level Managers met in February and October in Cyprus, sponsored by the International Management Development Institute at the University of Pittsburgh.
1996	Bi-Communal Conflict Resolution Trainers workshop met for 9 months to identify the fears, concerns and obstacles to resolution. It found 12 categories of obstacles and created a Vision Map to provide direction for CR workshops and to overcome the obstacles identified.
1996 - present	The Cyprus American Scholarship Program (CASP) holds a two week intensive summer program yearly in inter-communal confidence building workshops at School for International Training in Vermont for college aged participants-recipients of CASP scholarships to study in the United States.
1996	6-week seminar took place to discuss identity, commonalities and uniqueness of Cypriot culture.
1996	Journalist Workshop for editors was held in Washington D.C.
1996	Internet Workshop (Cyprus)
1996	Senior Business group formed
1997	Youth peace camps continued.
1997	Mid Level Managers workshops took place in February, March, and October in Cyprus, sponsored by the International Management Development Institute at the University of Pittsburgh.
1997	Senior Level Executives workshop in Pittsburgh (USA) by the International Management Development Institute at the University of Pittsburgh
1997	Brussels Women's Group
1997	Bi-communal Business Forum formed in response to the Brussels theme "in economic cooperation lies mutual benefit." This Forum focused on economic development and identified large economic asymmetries that existed.
1997	Bi-communal Youth group formed which was very critical of the political culture and leadership and the structural and institutional violence called Youth Encounters for Peace (YEP).

1997	Interactive Management workshops with student groups and citizen groups continued.
1997	Training of Trainers for Interactive Management skills continued.
1997	The First Four Party (GC, TC, Greek and Turkish) Interactive Management workshop was held in Le Diableret, Switzerland.
1997	Co Villagers Project began
1997	Confidence building workshops continued.
1997	Conference on civic education on developing NGOs.
1997	Speaker Program organized by Fulbright. Presenters included Carley and Sisk and topics included Negotiation and Mediation in Intractable conflicts.
1997	Journalist Workshop held in D.C. for working journalists.
1977	Conflict Resolution Facilitation Workshop held in DC.
1997	Federalism workshop held in Philadelphia.
1997	Special Investigators workshops held in DC and Miami.
1997	Labor Leaders workshop held.
1997	Local Governance in a Federal System workshop held.
1997	Proliferation of groups, including: Artists, Identity seminar, HADE magazine, Federation group, Internet group, Youth encounters for peace, Young environmentalists, Environmental groups, co-villagers, University students I and II, Management group, Lawyers, and Accountants.
1997	Conflict Management and Mediation workshops by Marco Turk for TC women's group, mental healthcare professionals, Domestic Violence Crisis Centre, Cyprus Police Academy, citizens groups, youth groups, American International School teachers, and UN Humanitarian troops.
1997	Administration of Justice workshop by Marco Turk

1997-1998	Intractability Project, Cyprus Consortium, consisting of 4 bi-communal workshops to analyse and address the elements of intractability.
1997	Mediation Training for Lawyers by Marco Turk
1997	Family Peace Makers Bi Communal Training by Marco Turk
1997	Family Peace Makers, Psychiatric Community Nurses (GC) workshop by Marco Turk
1998	Family Peace Makers workshop for Health Care Professionals in the north by Marco Turk
1998	Training for the Mental Health Care Professionals held by Marco Turk
1998	Training for Psychologists by Marco Turk
1998	Cyprus Police training by Marco Turk
1998	Cyprus Police training II held by Marco Turk
1998	Humanistic Mediation Training workshop by Marco Turk
1998	Mediation Workshop for Adolescents by Marco Turk
1998	Introduction to Mediation in the Schools by Marco Turk
1998	Humanistic Conflict Management Skills by Marco Turk
1998	Family Peace Makers training for Cyprus Turkish Women's Movement for Peace and Federal Solution by Marco Turk
1998	Family Peace Makers Training for Brussels Women's Group Marco Turk
1998	Family Peace Makers Training for Citizens Group by Marco Turk
1998	Mediation Training for Mixed Spouses by Marco Turk
1998	Tech 4 Peace website established.
1998	www.peace-cyprus.org established which posted petitions on basic needs and beliefs about a solution. A letter was then sent to the UN

which was signed by 41 grassroots organizations urging a speedy solution.

1998	Curriculum Development workshop
1998	Environmental Pollution workshop conducted
1998	Banking in a Federal System workshop took place.
1998	World Peace Foundation Conference, Cyprus 2000: Divided or Federal? (USA)
1998	Young Leaders Network workshop in Israel facilitated by Ben Broome.
1998	Federal and Peace-building conference in Israel
1998	Federalism and Peacemaking workshops conducted by Dr. Elazar
1998 Johnson	Revitalizing the Heart of a City conference held, hosted by Dr.
1998	Young Leaders Network Conference took place in Egypt (Peres Conference)
1998	Federalism and Peacemaking workshops conducted by Dr. Elazar.
1998	Youth Camps took place, sponsored by Seeds of Peace and SIT.
1998	Peacebuilding Conflict Intervention Training Skills workshop took place in Oslo (Oslo I)
1998	Peacebuilding Conflict Intervention Training Skills workshop took place in Oslo (Oslo II).
1998 – 2005	Bi Communal Development Programme (BDP), sponsoring design and implementation of projects of common interest between Greek and Turkish Cypriots. Worked with over 300 different Cypriot organizations and supported some 220 projects, including: ▪ Open Public Panel Discussions on Cyprus, <i>Association for Social Reform (OPEK) in association with a range of civil society organizations</i> ▪ Understanding Bi-communal Perceptions and Attitudes, <i>The Peace Centre</i> ▪ Bi-communal Perceptions of the Annan Plan, <i>Cyprus Sociological Association</i>

- The Information Project - Website, Panel Discussions and Training, *PRIO (International Peace Research Institute, Oslo)*
- The Harvard Study Group: A Bi-communal Multi-stakeholder Dialogue, *Harvard University*
- Youth Promoting Peace: Bi-communal Youth Peace Activities, *Youth Promoting Peace*
- Support Centres for NGOs including Training Programmes, *Association of Management Studies, Cyprus Turkish Association of Managers, Management Centre, UNOPS Direct Execution*
- Establishment of Mediation Centres, *Greek Cypriot Association of Mediation and North Cypriot Mediation Association*
- Conference on Federalism and Publication of Proceedings, *Centre for the Study of Federalism and Self-Government*
- Conference and Education Centre, *Cyprus Turkish Medical Association*
- Short Course Bi-communal Summer School Programme, *United World Colleges Cyprus*
- Education for Peace: A Study of Bias in History and Social Science Course Books, *AKTI, POST*
- Parallel Trips: Production of a Documentary on Greek Cypriot and Turkish Cypriot Families, *Artimages*
- Gimme6 Bi-communal TV Series for Children: Building Tolerance and Mutual Understanding Through Media, *Search for Common Ground*
- Bi-communal Comedy Series Script Preparation, *Tariman Productions, Camera-Stylo Recording Arts Productions*
- Cypriot Folk Dance Performance
- Preparation of First Bilingual (Turkish/Greek) Edition of an Arts Magazine
- Bi-communal Theatre Productions
- Bi-communal Development and Production of Dance/Theatre Performance
- Bi-communal Conference on Prospects for a United Cyprus
- Bi-communal Communication and Cooperation Seminar
- Bi-communal May Day Celebration in Limassol
- Bi-communal Peace Celebration in Limassol
- Peace Concert
- Cyprus Olympic Truce Declaration
- Bi-communal Voyage of Understanding – Tall Ships Sailing Trip for Cypriot Youth
- Translation of Book on Political and Social Issues for the PEO Cyprus Labour Institute
- Bi-communal Children's Camp in Ayios Nicholas
- Children's Congress

- Conference on Early Childhood
- Rockathon: Merging Cultures: Bi-communal Music Event
- Bi-communal Conference on Gender in the Mediterranean: Emerging Discourses and Practices
- International Women's Day Celebration
- Empowering Young Women for Success – Workshop For Young Women
- Internet Forum for Civic Expression
- Preparations for Beijing NGO Conference
- Pan European NGO Seminar
- Civil Society Common Initiative Panel Discussion
- 14th International Conference of the Alliance of Universities for Democracy
- International Conference on Violence
- 4th Global Conference on Cultures of Violence
- HIV/AIDs Conference
- World AIDS Day Celebration
- Public Education on HIV/AIDS and STD Prevention
- International Thalassemia Conference
- International Cardiology Forum
- Conference on Laparoscopic Surgery
- Conference for the Deaf
- World Environment Day
- Training of Facilitators for Rural Land Use Decision-Making Processes
- Focus Group
- Human Rights Festival
- Conference: 'Scientific word of Civilisation

1999 - 2001	The Harvard Study Group brought together mid to high level influentials over six meetings to directly discuss the major issues of the conflict and to propose options for resolution.
1999	Advanced Mediation Training and Techniques workshop by Marco Turk for Cyprus Police
1999	CASP Scholars Emil and Marion Angelica held workshops on the role of NGOs
1999	International Conference on Sub-National Constitutionalism
1999	Historic Cities Conference conducted by Dr. Johnson
1999	Conflict Resolution CASP Scholars workshop at Duquesne University

- 1999 Curriculum Development II workshops held by Dr. Dickens at James Madison University
- 1999 Water Management Program held, STT
- 1999 Local Governance in a Federal System I lectures conducted by Dr. Kinkaïd in Cyprus
- 1999 Seeds of Peace Summer Camp held.
- 1999 Academic Groups traveled to Israel for workshops. These were supported by the Fulbright Commission.
- 1999 Local Governance in a Federal System II by Dr. Kincaid in the USA
- 1999 Distance Learning workshop held in Finland
- 1999 Geographical Information Systems workshop took place in USA
- 1999 USIS NATO Journalist Tour took place in Italy
- 1999 Inauguration of Jerusalem Seeds of Peace (SOP) Center, October
- 1999 Women Waging Peace (WWP) Conference took place. The Fulbright Commission was the Local Partner for Ambassador Swanee Hunt's WWP initiative.
- 1999 Robert Rotberg (Harvard) lecture in Cyprus
- 1999 Cypriot Youth held an event at Pergamos Park, a mixed village, to enjoy music and dancing

2000s

- 2000 Youth Encounters for Peace organized a meeting in Pyla. This was the first locally owned peacebuilding workshop with no third party. It brought together teachers, local facilitators, youth, and people living in mixed villages totaling hundreds of Cypriots.
- 2000 Bi-communal group of CR trainers met in Neve Shalom, Israel to stress the need to intensify efforts at official and unofficial diplomatic levels to change status quo.
- 2000 Seeds of Peace started their youth oriented project

2000	Center for Democracy and Reconciliation in Southeastern Europe conducted workshops on textbooks and history teaching. These workshops were held at Pyla village with the participation of TC and GC and Turkish and Greek academics.
2000	Liver Anesthesiology workshop in January – February
2000	Seeds of Peace workshop in January in Jerusalem with a second due to take place in October, but was cancelled due to trouble in the area.
2000	Civil Military course at Harvard in April
2000	Stock Exchange workshop
2000	CASP Conflict Resolution workshop for senior and graduate students in May
2000	CASP Confidence Building workshop for sophomores in August
2000	Apple Chambers Players workshop held in Israel in February
2000	Women in Business workshop held in June
2000	Domestic Violence workshop held in July
2000	Three youth camps were held during the summer
2000	A Special Education workshop was held in July
2000	Sustainable Planning workshop held in July
2000	Emergency Management workshop held in September
2000	Historic Preservation Workshop held in August
2000	Workshop for Teachers on Conflict Resolution Skills held in August
2000	Education Administration workshop held in September
2000	A Standards of Care in Nursing workshop was held in November
2000	An Uncommon past project – a common future (Juliette Dickstein – Sept 11, 2000 to March 11, 2001)

2000	Workshop on the establishment of setting up a health center for domestic violence victims, November 2000
2000	Asbestos Workshop held in November
2000	Peter Sulski held a Community Building workshop via Music from December 2000 to April 2002.
2000	Empowerment of Women Follow up workshop held Cyprus
2001	Two Centres were established, The Management centre in the TCC and the NGO Support Centre in the GCC in order to support and strengthen the civil society and reconciliation activities.
2001	Dr. David Schnall – Lectures on NGOs in January
2001	Intensive Care in Nursing workshop held in March
2001	An Intensive English and Drug Awareness program, summer
2001	American Studies Colloquium held
2001	Two Summer Youth Camps held
2001	Drug Awareness and Prevention for Professionals workshop held in the fall
2001	CASP in residence for Drug Awareness and Prevention for 7 months – R Kibben
2001	Administering a Rehabilitation and Therapeutic Center workshop held in November
2001	Conflict Resolution workshop for CASP students
2001	Confidence Building workshop for CASP students
2002	Children's Art for Peace Program
2002	Information Technology workshop
2002	Drug Prevention Workshop Number 3
2002	Two Youth Camps
2002	CASP Conflict Resolution

2002	CASP Confidence Building
2002	Motivational Interviewing in Crete – R Kibben/A Demirjian
2003	<i>“Search for Common Ground”</i> initiated a program for school children
2003	Prime for Life – Cyprus Based
2003	American Studies Colloquium
2003	CASP Confidence Building Workshop
2003	CASP Conflict Resolution Workshop
2003	Youth Camp
2003	Community Building via music – Margerie Gere
2003 – present	Hands Across the Divide, a bi-communal women’s NGO, formed to carry out joint actions for peace. Currently is working to revive Famagusta including Varosha. IT works along with the New Cyprus Party (YKP), German Cypriot Forum, Friends of Nature Cyprus, TC Teachers Trade Union (KTOS), Cyprus Art Association (KSD), Rights and Freedoms Association
2003 – present	Association for Historical Dialogue and Research founded, working on projects on education and to develop trainings for teachers for the new history textbooks in the north.
2004 - present	Cyprus Bold Leaders Youth Camp (sponsored by US Embassy’s Bi-communal Support Program) to provide thirty Cypriot youth with a 21 day experience that breaks down pre-conceived stereotypes, provides an opening for greater relatedness, understanding, and compassion, and fosters a commitment to becoming future leaders of peace in their homeland.
2004	Summer Academic Term
2004	Family Law in a Federal System (Judges, US)
2004	NAADAC Certification (bi communal training in substance abuse)
2004	Fulbright Scholar, Jay Noller, CASP funding for Geophormological Research

2004	Council of Europe – co funded seminar on Reform of History Textbooks
2004	Follow up youth programs – John Ungerleider
2004	Conflict Resolution Workshops for CASP students
2004	Confidence Building Workshop for CASP students
2004	Drug Prevention projects – Ernestos Randolphi
2005	Youth Camp
2005	Summer Academic Term
2005	American Colloquium
2005	CASP Conflict Resolution Workshop
2005	CASP Confidence Building Workshop
2005	Margerie Gere – Community Building via music
2005 – present	UNDP-Action for Cooperation and Trust (ACT) launched in October 2005 to replace the Bi Communal Development Programme. Provides funding and coordination support for projects that are designed and implemented by Cypriots, and which in turn actively promote inter-communal cooperation, focusing in multicultural education, civil society strengthening and promoting sustainable development. The project funds over 100 projects, including: ▪ Conflict Resolution & Peace Education (CRE/PE), by Mediation Association, KAYAD, Peace Centre, British Council ▪ History Teacher Training Project by the Centre for Democracy and Reconciliation in Southeast Europe (CDRSEE) ▪ Provision of Multicultural Youth Camp Training by International Child Development Initiatives ▪ Playing for Peace by Playing for Peace ▪ Youth Dialogue project ▪ The Madison Dairy Advisory Group (MADAG) offering technical expertise to all dairy farmers on the island. ▪ The Cyprus Organics Advisory Group (COAG) composed of organic farming experts and aims to share expertise,

information and guidance on matters related to the production and consumption of organic products in Cyprus.

- Emergency Disease Forum of leading veterinary and health experts to ensure a rapid and coordinated island-wide response to any public health emergency.
- Cyprus Environmental Stakeholder Forum, to create the conditions for the eventual establishment of a bi-communal platform of environmental stakeholders willing to agree on a list of common environmental priorities which they will advocate together at international environmental events.

2005 – 2007	Doves Olympic Movement, camps for 100 children
2006	Six youth camps with over 260 participants, sponsored by UNDP-ACT
2006	Summer Academic Term
2006	CASP Conflict Resolution Workshop
2006	The Peace Centre: Coexistence and Diversity Matter. Camp for 40 participants i.e. 10 Greek, 10 Turkish, 10 Greek Cypriots and 10 Turkish Cypriots on a week-long camp in partnership with WINPEACE.
2006	ESC Environmental Studies Centre (Kritou Terra): Environmental Summer Programmes for young educators and young citizens. Three residential camps on environment, education and conservation issues for trainees, young teachers and secondary school pupils to raise environmental awareness in both communities.
2006	CLTS Centre for Leisure, Tourism and Sport Research and Development: Doves Olympic Movement. Camp for sport and educational activities for 120 children.
2006	Tall Ships Youth Trust: European Voyage of Understanding. Brought together 12 Cypriots from both communities to join a crew of 36 other young people from Europe to sail for 10 days on a square-rigged ship from Gibraltar to Minorca in the Mediterranean.
2006	Frederick Institute of Technology: Camping, Fitness and Education- CA.F.E. Camp for 40 young Greek and Turkish Cypriots to promote mutual respect and tolerance among Cypriots and promote the concept of a 'Healthy mind in a healthy body'.

2006	KAYAD Community Centre: “Together Anything is possible.” 26 young people (13 Greek Cypriots / 13 Turkish Cypriots) brought together in a 10-day camp focused on community service projects of common interest for both communities.
2006 – present	Cyprus Civil Society Strengthening Programme run by The Management centre and NGO Support Centre sponsored by UNDP-ACT
2006 – present	Anti-TIP NGO Capacity Building, supported by the US Embassy’s Bi-communal Support Program, to
2007	American Studies Workshop
2007	Youth Program
2007	Summer Academic Term
2007	CASP Conflict Resolution Workshop
2007	Anti-Racism, Anti-Nationalist Group was formed in reaction to events at the English School.
2007	‘Let’s Unite our Beautiful Island’ is a youth group which is organized on Face Book. Its first meeting of youth, parents and family took place on 6 August 2007.
2007	Eight youth camps sponsored by UNDP-ACT
2007	Frederick Research Centre: Environmental Education for Educators-3E
2007	Limassol Traditional Karate Association: Building cells of true tolerance and multiculturalism through traditional karate. Brings together about 50 children of the different communities of Cyprus (Greek Cypriots, Turkish Cypriots, Armenian Cypriot and Maronite Cypriots) in a year-long training programme in traditional karate.
2007	ESC Environmental Studies Centre (Kritou Terra) 1. Environmental Camp for Secondary School Teachers 2. Environmental Camp for Primary School Teachers 3. Environmental Camp for High School Students

2007	Municipality of Idalion: Camp Against Racism (CAR). Camp and subsequent establishment of a network against racism in Dali. The participants will also actively engage in a theatrical performance dealing with anti-racism as a follow up to the camp.
2007	KAYAD Community Centre: Together Anything is Possible.
2007 Beginners	Soma Akriton Youth Organisation: Volunteerism Lessons for Soma Akriton organises year-long activities that set up a step by step training for 200 children, teenagers and young people for promoting volunteerism.
2007	University of Cyprus: Science Youth Camp - Science Camp for Girls for 50 girls aged 11-14
2007	Doves Olympic Movement: Building a common future through sport and education
2007	Corporate Social Responsibility training for up-and-coming Cypriot businessmen and women over 9 weeks in Cyprus and Seattle, Washington.
2007	Athens Journalists Symposium

Categories of Peacebuilding Programs/Initiatives

In order to better understand the nature and evolution of peacebuilding efforts in Cyprus over time, we have devised 12 categories under which most of the peacebuilding programs fall. Many programs can be classified under more than one of the categories, but the categories are designed to facilitate understanding of the types of programs that have been undertaken over time, and the intensity and focus of programming.

The categories are as follows:

- 1- Education: programs/initiatives by academics, for academics and educators, focused on the educational system/curricula, academic conferences on topics of joint interest to Greek Cypriots and Turkish Cypriots, and training, camps and other educational experience for youth and students.
- 2- Conflict Resolution: programs/initiatives, including training, dialogue, research and activities, focused specifically on gaining a better understanding, mastery or knowledge of principles and practice of conflict resolution, especially in the Cyprus context.
- 3- Dialoguing Events: direct dialogue, discussion, and problem solving between Turkish Cypriots and Greek Cypriots, either on issues concerning the Cyprus problem or on other problems (e.g., environment) of joint concern to both sides.

- 4- Management: programs working with managers or on management issues.
- 5- Youth and Business Leaders: work with youth (from school-age to young politicians) and businesspeople.
- 6- Women's Groups: women's groups working on peace issues or joint groups working on issues related to gender and women's rights.
- 7- Cultural Events: Bi-communal cultural events, ranging from concerts and art exhibits to celebrations of environment, human rights and other public events.
- 8- Negotiation and Mediation Groups: training and work on negotiation and mediation skills.
- 9- Federalist Group: groups and workshops exploring federalism in the context of Cyprus, in comparative perspective.
- 10- Mix Groups: mixed groups of Greek Cypriots and Turkish Cypriots doing projects together.
- 11- Activities/Trainings for Professions: activities and trainings targeting specific professions (e.g., investigators, doctors, etc.)
- 12- Programs for NGOs and CSOs: programs related to the strengthening of civil society.

The highest concentration of programs from the 1980s – present is in education and youth: trainings, youth camps, conferences and workshops in particular academic or professional areas. This has been consistent from the 1980s. Cultural events and activities have been undertaken and received consistent support over the years as well.

At the same time, there have been fewer direct conflict resolution and dialogue activities after 2000, although many of the youth trainings and camps often incorporate some conflict resolution skills work into their programs. Dialogue activities have continued, but many now focus on professional or practical areas of joint interest to Greek Cypriots and Turkish Cypriots, rather than on the Cyprus problem. This trend reflects a shift in funding support to programs for NGOs and CSOs (civil society strengthening) and to activities and trainings for professions and a shift to an approach of promoting inter-communal reconciliation and cooperation through strengthening civil society's capacity to make its voice heard on policy issues, and promoting cooperation in areas of common interest.